

Expansion Economics

Hook:

This is Brayden White, and welcome to the inaugural episode of BOW Sports Capital. "Picture this: It's 2004. The NBA adds the Charlotte Bobcats, the last time the league expanded. The cost? A measly 300 million dollars. Fast forward twenty years — the league is booming, Las Vegas is the new sports capital, and Seattle fans still want their Sonics back. The price tag for each new team? Four to five billion dollars. That's nearly ten billion dollars straight into the owners' pockets. Sounds like easy money, right? But here's the catch: does expansion actually make economic sense for the NBA? And just as important — who wins, and who loses if it happens?"

Background (Set the Stage)

"Expansion is not new for the NBA. Back in the 80s and 90s, teams like the Heat, the Raptors, and the Timberwolves came into the league. Expansion brought in new fans and markets, but it also stretched the talent pool and changed how money was shared.

Fast forward to today. The NBA is more global, its TV deals are massive, and new cities like Las Vegas are booming with sports. Seattle fans also still want their Sonics back. On paper, expansion looks exciting. But the money side is more complicated."

Winners (Short-Term)

"So let's start with the winners.

First, the **owners**. Expansion fees don't go to the league office—they go straight into the pockets of current team owners. If each new team pays about four or five billion, that's around \$250 to \$300 million for every current owner. That's a huge payday.

Next, the **new cities**. Vegas and Seattle would gain thousands of jobs, more tourism, and of course, a new fan base. Local businesses and sponsors would benefit too.

And finally, the **media companies**. More teams mean more games to broadcast, more commercials to sell, and more content for fans to watch."

Losers (Long-Term Risks)

"But not everyone wins.

Players could lose out. Why? Because the salary cap is tied to basketball-related income. If revenue per team shrinks after expansion, player salaries may not grow as fast as they would have otherwise. Plus, spreading talent across more teams could water down competition.

Existing teams also face risks. Right now, TV revenue is divided by 30 teams. Add two more, and suddenly the pie is being split 32 ways. That means smaller annual checks unless the league grows enough to make up the difference.

And then there's the **league overall**. Expansion can hurt quality in the short term. Remember how bad some expansion teams were in their first years? More weak teams can mean less exciting games, which could hurt ratings."

Takeaway & Challenge

"So, does expansion make sense?

If you're an owner, probably yes. If you're a player, maybe no. If you're the commissioner, it's tough. Expansion grows the league's footprint but could make the product weaker in the short run.

Remember, when the Hornets re-entered the league in 2004, they didn't make the playoffs for six years. That's the risk: weaker teams, less exciting games, and lower ratings."

"Now it's your turn — step into the commissioner's chair at BOW Sports Capital. Approve expansion or shut it down, back it up with your reasoning, and we'll let you know if your call holds up."

And get ready for next week's case: *The Supermax Problem*. NBA stars sign monster contracts worth hundreds of millions of dollars, but do these deals actually help teams win — or do they trap franchises? That's what we'll explore in Episode 2.

Until then, I'm Brayden, and this was BOW Sports Capital.

1. yes 2. interactive challenge google form spreadsheet activity or quiz 3. fun competitive but also a little analytical 5. simulate

Clutch Highlights

Hook (Slide 1)

“Game 7. Tie score. Ten seconds left. Who do you trust with the ball? Everybody’s got an answer: maybe it’s Dame, maybe Kawhi, maybe Reggie. But here’s the real question: do those so-called clutch moments actually make a player more valuable — or is clutch just hype? Today, we’re putting it to the test with the first-ever BOW Sports Capital Highlight Draft.”

Part 1 — Myth vs Reality: The Stats Primer (Slide 2)

“Let’s start with the numbers. In the NBA, ‘clutch’ means the last five minutes of a game within five points. Kobe is remembered as one of the coldest killers ever — but he only hit about 31% of his game-winning shots. LeBron gets clowned for not being clutch, but his playoff clutch percentage is actually better than MJ’s.

Baseball? David Ortiz is ‘Mr. October,’ but his postseason OPS was basically the same as his career OPS. And football? We all know Tom Brady — 46 comebacks, 58 game-winning drives. He’s the one guy where the stats actually match the legend.

So yeah, clutch moments are real, but the numbers show they aren’t always what they seem.”

Part 2 — The Sob Story: Duped by Clutch

“Here’s when clutch hype can kill you. Mid-2000s, Gilbert Arenas — Agent Zero. Dude was hitting buzzer-beaters, pulling from deep, had all the swagger. The Wizards bought in big — \$111 million extension. And then? Injuries, bad efficiency, and the gun suspension. His contract turned into one of the worst in NBA history. Washington basically paid for highlights, not production. They paid for clutch, and it backfired.”

Part 3 — The Success Story: Clutch Paid Off

“But sometimes clutch changes everything. Think about David Ortiz in 2004. The Red Sox hadn’t won in 86 years. Ortiz hits back-to-back walk-offs against the Yankees, and suddenly the curse is broken. His stats weren’t that different from his regular season, but the *moments*? Legendary. Fenway packed every night, jerseys everywhere, and Ortiz became Boston’s hero. Clutch hype actually paid off.”

Part 4 — The Money Story: Why Clutch = Cash

“And that’s the real debate. One clutch shot doesn’t just win a game — it can change the money. More ticket sales, more TV money, more jerseys. When Dame hit that 37-footer to wave OKC goodbye, his ‘Dame Time’ brand went global overnight. The analytics say clutch is shaky, but the economics say clutch is priceless.”

Part 5 — The Highlight Draft (Slides 3–12)

“Alright, now it’s your turn. We made a draft board of nine of the craziest clutch highlights in sports. But this isn’t just about ranking highlights — it’s about thinking like a GM. Imagine you’re sitting at the table, and a player’s agent says, ‘Pay my guy max money.’ Would you hand over the bag just because of this one play?

Here’s the board:

- **Basketball:** Dame’s 37-footer vs OKC (2019). Kawhi’s four-bounce buzzer vs the Sixers (2019). Ray Allen’s Finals-saving three (2013). Reggie Miller’s 8 points in 9 seconds (1995). Robert Horry’s Game 5 dagger in the 2005 Finals.
- **Football:** David Tyree’s helmet catch (2008). The Minnesota Miracle — Keenum to Diggs (2018).
- **Baseball:** Big Papi’s walk-off vs Yankees (2004). Kirk Gibson’s limp-off homer (1988).

You get three picks — Round 1, Round 2, Round 3. Build your clutch portfolio. Which moments are you betting on? We’ll count the votes and reveal the draft board on our website.”

Part 6 — Wrap (Slide 13)

“So here’s the lesson. The stats say clutch is inconsistent — guys who look unstoppable in the moment usually fall back to normal. But the business side? Clutch moments are priceless. Teams aren’t just buying wins when they pay for clutch. They’re buying stories. Stories that fans never forget.”

Outro

“That’s Episode 1 of BOW Sports Capital. Should teams pay for clutch — or is it just hype? Go draft your highlight portfolio, and we’ll see which clutch moments came out on top on the website.”

MODULE 1 FOR ALL LEVELS

● 101 — Rookie GM (Basics)

Audience: upper elementary / middle school beginners

- **Lesson 1: *What is a Salary Cap?***
 - Episode: simple allowance analogy.
 - Activity: ☒ Roster Sheet (8 players, must keep 2 stars under \$136M).
 - **Lesson 2: *Luxury Tax Basics***
 - Episode: “What happens if you overspend?” (dollar-for-dollar fine).
 - Activity: Slides branching story — choose “spend” or “save” → see outcomes.
 - **Lesson 3: *Second Apron Made Simple***
 - Episode: “Why the league punishes super-spenders.”
 - Activity: Form quiz — Which trades are legal under Apron? (very simplified).
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● 201 — Pro GM (Intermediate)

Audience: middle / early HS students

- **Lesson 1: *Salary Cap Mechanics***
 - Episode: exceptions, veteran minimums.
 - Activity: ☒ Pro roster sheet (12 players, 3 stars, tax formula built in).
 - **Lesson 2: *Luxury Tax in Action***
 - Episode: Case study: Warriors \$300M payroll → \$200M tax.
 - Activity: Spreadsheet where tax auto-calculates; build roster with penalties.
 - **Lesson 3: *Second Apron Challenge***
 - Episode: “How the Apron changes team building.”
 - Activity: Trade scenario sheet — must find one legal trade under Apron.
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● 301 — Certified Agent (Advanced)

Audience: HS juniors/seniors, admissions portfolio work

- **Lesson 1: *Real Cap Sheets***
 - Episode: How front offices use Excel/Spotrac.
 - Activity: ☒ Simplified real payroll (Warriors/Clippers), calculate payroll + penalties.
- **Lesson 2: *Luxury Tax Economics***
 - Episode: How tax affects team strategy + CBA context.
 - Activity: Compare 2 real teams (one tax, one no tax). Reflection: which is smarter?

- **Lesson 3: *Second Apron Case Study***
 - Episode: Deep dive: 2023 CBA changes.
 - Activity: Case study: given a real team, ID trades blocked by Apron and propose a fix.

ALL MODULES MASTERSHEET

Track 101 — Rookie GM 101 (Intro Concepts)

Theme: Learn the basics of how teams manage players, money, and value.

Module 1 — Salary Cap Fundamentals

1. Lesson 1: What is the Salary Cap?
2. Lesson 2: Exceptions and Soft Caps
3. Lesson 3: Minimums, Maximums, and Luxury Tax
4. Lesson 4: Rookie Contracts & Bird Rights

Module 2 — Player Evaluation

1. Lesson 1: Advanced Stats vs Box Score
2. Lesson 2: Role Player vs Star Value
3. Lesson 3: Team Fit and Positional Need
4. Lesson 4: Cap Efficiency Case Study

Module 3 — Team Building 101

1. Lesson 1: Draft, Trade, Free Agency Pathways
2. Lesson 2: Balancing Stars and Depth
3. Lesson 3: Building Around a Superstar
4. Lesson 4: Case Study — 2015 Warriors Roster Build

Module 4 — Negotiation Basics

1. Lesson 1: How NBA Contracts Are Negotiated
 2. Lesson 2: The Role of an Agent
 3. Lesson 3: Rookie Extensions and Team Options
 4. Lesson 4: Negotiation Simulation Challenge
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Track 201 — Front Office 201 (Intermediate Strategy)

Theme: Deeper analysis of how teams create long-term success.

Module 1 — Cap Crash (Economics in Action)

1. Lesson 1: Cap Crunches and Overages
2. Lesson 2: Dead Money and Buyouts
3. Lesson 3: Trade Exceptions and TPEs
4. Lesson 4: Real GM Simulation — Fixing a Team's Cap Sheet

Module 2 — Draft Room Analytics

1. Lesson 1: WAR, PER, and RAPTOR Metrics
2. Lesson 2: Building Draft Models
3. Lesson 3: Evaluating Player Archetypes
4. Lesson 4: Case Study — Finding a Hidden Gem

Module 3 — Trade Machine Mastery

1. Lesson 1: CBA Trade Rules Overview

2. Lesson 2: Salary Matching and Aggregation
3. Lesson 3: Multi-Team Trades
4. Lesson 4: Challenge — Pull Off a Legal Trade

Module 4 — GM Psychology

1. Lesson 1: Risk and Reward in Roster Decisions
 2. Lesson 2: Timing the Market
 3. Lesson 3: The Pressure of Public Perception
 4. Lesson 4: Case Study — The Harden Trade
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Track 301 — Pro GM 301 (Advanced + Simulation Tier)

Theme: High-level analysis, negotiations, and simulations at pro scale.

Module 1 — Franchise Strategy

1. Lesson 1: Contend or Rebuild?
2. Lesson 2: Asset Management & Pick Hoarding
3. Lesson 3: Long-Term Cap Projection
4. Lesson 4: Case Study — Sam Presti & OKC Thunder

Module 2 — The Agent's Playbook

1. Lesson 1: Contract Structure Breakdown
2. Lesson 2: Opt-Out Clauses, Player Options, and Incentives

3. Lesson 3: Case Study — Jalen Brunson Contract
4. Lesson 4: Bonus Episode — Real Agent Negotiation Flow

Module 3 — Advanced Metrics Lab

1. Lesson 1: Predictive Models for Player Value
2. Lesson 2: Building Your Own PCVI (Player Contract Value Index)
3. Lesson 3: Cross-Sport Comparisons (NBA/NFL)
4. Lesson 4: Case Study — PCVI Application Challenge

Module 4 — Capstone: Run Your Franchise

1. Lesson 1: Assemble Your Team Under the Cap
2. Lesson 2: Handle Free Agency and the Draft
3. Lesson 3: Navigate Trades, Injuries, and Extensions
4. Lesson 4: Final Simulation — Submit Your GM Portfolio

301

TRACK 301 — FINALIZED STRUCTURE (ACTIVITIES FIXED)

MODULE 2

SPORTS THEME: THE BUSINESS SIDE OF WINNING

How money, risk, and demand shape what “winning” actually means.

Lesson 2 — Risk, Volatility, and Rational Aggression

Podcast (unchanged direction)

- Winning as an **investment**
 - High-variance vs low-variance teams
 - Fans judge outcomes; front offices judge distributions
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Regular Activity (Sports-Themed, Creative)

“Championship Dice” Activity

Students see **three real-looking team profiles**:

- Star-heavy contender
- Balanced playoff team
- Young volatile team

Each team shows:

- Playoff odds distribution
- Title odds
- Collapse risk

Task (choice-based):

- Pick which team you would *run* in:
 - Big market
 - Mid market
 - Small market

No justification required. Just choice + context.



MODULE 2 SYNTHESIS (PURE ECONOMICS)

Economic Concepts Tested:

- Expected value vs variance
- Risk tolerance
- Intertemporal tradeoffs

MCQ / Logic Examples:

- Two strategies have equal expected wins. Which owner prefers which and why?
- Which environment rationally tolerates higher variance?
- Identify the *incorrect* interpretation of risk.

Goal:

Students prove they can **separate outcome from strategy**.

Claim Code: mastery-gated

Lesson 3 — Fan Demand & Market Response



Regular Activity (Sports-Themed)

“Attendance Shock” Simulator

Students see:

- Same team improves from 38 → 45 wins
- Applied to:
 - New York
 - Milwaukee
 - Memphis

They watch attendance, sponsorship, and media interest react differently.

Task:

- Choose where spending “worked”
- Choose where it didn’t



MODULE 2 FINAL SYNTHESIS (PURE ECON)

Economic Concepts Tested:

- Elastic vs inelastic demand
- Marginal revenue
- Incentive alignment

MCQs Include:

- Where does an extra win create the most revenue?
- Identify the market with the flattest demand curve
- Which statement confuses profit with performance?

Sports language removed entirely here.

MODULE 3

SPORTS THEME: ROSTER BUILDING UNDER PRESSURE

Why constraints force tradeoffs and eliminate “perfect” teams.

Lesson 1 — Constraints Shape Roster Strategy



Regular Activity (Sports-Themed)

“Same Roster, Different League”

Students see **the exact same roster** placed into:

- NBA rules
- NFL rules
- MLB rules

Some moves become illegal or impossible.

Task:

- Identify which roster moves break

- Identify which survive
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MODULE 3 SYNTHESIS CHECK (ECON)

Economic Concepts:

- Scarcity
- Budget constraints
- Feasible sets

MCQs:

- Which option lies outside the feasible set?
 - Which constraint is binding?
 - Which relaxation changes the solution?
-

Lesson 2 — Opportunity Cost in Team Building



Regular Activity (Sports-Themed)

“The Flexibility Budget”

Students spend a limited pool of:

- Cap space
- Picks
- Exceptions

Later rounds remove options.

Task:

- Experience loss of flexibility
 - Feel tradeoffs without math
-

MODULE 3 SYNTHESIS CHECK

Economic Concepts:

- Opportunity cost
- Allocation efficiency

MCQs:

- Which cost is unseen?
 - Which option sacrifices future flexibility?
 - Which plan dominates under scarcity?
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Lesson 3 — Risk vs Uncertainty

Regular Activity (Sports-Themed)

“Known vs Unknown Prospects”

Students choose between:

- Player with known distribution
- Player with hidden variance

Same average outcome.

MODULE 3 FINAL SYNTHESIS (PURE ECON)

Economic Concepts:

- Risk vs uncertainty
- Information asymmetry

MCQs:

- Which situation contains uncertainty, not risk?
 - Why do decision-makers prefer known variance?
 - Identify the false equivalence.
-

MODULE 4

SPORTS THEME: WHY DYNASTIES EXIST

How systems, not just talent, produce long-run dominance.

Lesson 1 — League Rules & Competitive Balance



Regular Activity (Sports-Themed)

“Rewrite the League”

Students toggle:

- Draft order
- Revenue sharing
- Tax severity

They watch dominance rise or fall.

MODULE 4 SYNTHESIS CHECK

Economic Concepts:

- Regulation
- Redistribution
- Competitive equilibrium

MCQs:

- Which rule increases parity?
- Which creates persistence?
- Identify unintended consequences.

Lesson 2 — Path Dependence & Feedback Loops

Regular Activity (Sports-Themed)

“Early Break Simulation”

Teams that win early gain:

- Better players
- More money
- Better outcomes later

MODULE 4 SYNTHESIS CHECK

Economic Concepts:

- Increasing returns
- Path dependence

MCQs:

- Why does early success matter?
 - Which outcome shows lock-in?
 - Which reset breaks the loop?
-

Lesson 3 — Innovation & Imitation



Regular Activity (Sports-Themed)

“Copycat League”

One team innovates.
Others imitate.
Edge disappears.



MODULE 4 FINAL SYNTHESIS (PURE ECON)

Economic Concepts:

- Diffusion of innovation
- Temporary monopoly
- Competitive erosion

MCQs:

- Why does advantage decay?
- Which innovation lasts longest?

- Which statement confuses invention with dominance?
-

TRACK 301 CAPSTONE (ECON-ONLY)

No sports language. No narratives.

Tests:

- System recognition
- Tradeoff identification
- Intertemporal logic
- Equilibrium reasoning

Format:

- Advanced MCQs
- Dominance logic
- “Which system survives?” questions

Final Claim Code:

Signals **mastery** and readiness for Track 401.

Module 1 301

301 M1L1

Track 301 — Module 1, Lesson 1

“Timing Windows & Competitive Cycles”

Subtitle: *The smartest teams don't react to the market — they schedule around it.*

Intro

Alright, welcome back to *Bow Sports Capital*.

If you've made it this far, you already know the basics — what salary caps do, how the luxury tax works, and how teams navigate payroll.

Now we're going deeper.

This track is about how front offices plan — not for next season, but for the next three or four. Because it's one thing to manage a payroll; it's another to manage a **timeline**.

Every team talks about its “window” — those few years where everything lines up: your stars are in their prime, your roster fits, and your spending actually makes sense.

But those windows don't just happen.

Smart front offices **build** them.

They forecast when contracts will peak, when young players will hit their stride, and when league rules are about to shift.

And what works in one sport might be a disaster in another.

What fits under the NBA's soft cap wouldn't survive the NFL's hard one — and baseball doesn't have a cap at all.

So in this lesson, we're looking at how elite front offices manage **timing**, not just talent — how they create, extend, and reset their shot at a championship.

Part 1 — Every League Has Its Own Clock

Every league gives you a different clock to manage, and if you can't read it, you're done before you start.

MLB — The Service-Time Clock

In baseball, the clock starts the day a rookie takes the field.

Teams get six years of control — three at the league minimum, three through arbitration — before a player can hit free agency.

That's why front offices move early.
They know when value peaks, and they know it doesn't last forever.
It's not emotional. It's math.
Teams that thrive in baseball learn to refresh talent *before* contracts become anchors.

NFL — The Quarterback Window

In the NFL, everything revolves around one contract — the quarterback's.
When your QB is on a rookie deal, your window is open.
When that deal expires and the price skyrockets, flexibility disappears fast.
That's why so many front

You said:

oh also the activity is where u choose what to do with ur window for an mlb nba and nfl team and if u reach the correct score you will get an email with ur claim code

Podcast Pro said:

Perfect — that fits *exactly* with the tone and level of Track 301.
It keeps the “simulation” feel you want — but makes the activity cleaner, measurable, and totally professional.

Here's how the whole lesson now reads with that **new activity** built in and the script rewritten to sound 100 percent like *you* wrote it — conversational, smart, and source-neutral.

Track 301 — Module 1, Lesson 1

“Timing Windows & Competitive Cycles”

Subtitle: *The smartest teams don't react to the market — they schedule around it.*

Intro

Alright — welcome back to *Bow Sports Capital*.
If you've made it here, you already know how caps and payrolls work.
Now we're going one layer deeper: how front offices **plan**.

Because managing money is one skill — managing *timing* is the one that wins rings.

Every team talks about its “window.”
Those few seasons when the stars are peaking, the roster fits, and the budget actually

balances.

But windows don't just happen.

Front offices build them — projecting contracts, age curves, and CBA shifts years ahead.

And they all play different timing games:

what makes sense in the NBA would explode in the NFL, and baseball lives in its own world entirely.

So today, we're breaking down how great organizations manage timing — not just talent — and how they stretch, open, or reset their window to compete again.

Part 1 — Every League Has Its Own Clock

Every league gives you its own version of time pressure — and the ones that survive know exactly how fast theirs is ticking.

MLB — The Service-Time Clock

In baseball, the meter starts the day a rookie arrives.

Teams control that player for six seasons before free agency — and every year the cost climbs.

If you wait too long, payroll balloons before the team peaks.

So the smart ones build around pre-arbitration talent, trade ahead of decline, and stay light enough to reload fast.

NFL — The Quarterback Window

Football timing revolves around one contract: your QB.

When that deal is cheap, the window is wide open.

Once the extension hits, the roster tightens overnight.

That's why successful front offices stack talent early, restructure strategically, and treat the rookie-deal years like gold.

NBA — The Tax and Apron Cycle

Basketball's clock lives inside the luxury-tax system.

Once your core hits its big numbers, every extra signing costs more.

The new Second Apron makes flexibility even harder, so teams time their extensions carefully — pushing when depth is affordable, holding when the tax spikes.

Different clocks, same challenge: know when to move.

Part 2 — Forecasting the Window

Good teams plan for next season.
Great ones plan three down the road.

Every front office runs its own forecasting model — mapping salaries, player aging, and future cap changes.

The goal isn't just "who can we pay now?"
It's "who can we still afford when everything escalates?"

Smart executives use that model to spot the real pressure points — the seasons where they can afford to go heavy, and the ones where restraint buys longevity.

They treat payroll like an investment portfolio: balance short-term return against long-term flexibility.

When you zoom out, that's the pattern — lasting teams don't chase moments; they design cycles.

Part 3 — The Tradeoff Game

There's always a tradeoff.
Go all-in too early and you mortgage tomorrow.
Wait too long and your roster peaks in the rear-view mirror.

That tension — between pushing now and protecting later — is where real front-office skill shows up.

Timing is strategy.
It's not about *how much* you spend; it's about *when*.

Part 4 — Your Turn → Window Management Challenge

Now it's your turn to think like a GM.

You'll get **three fictional franchises** — one from each league.
Each has its own payroll situation, star ages, and upcoming rule changes.

For each team, you'll make a sequence of decisions over four seasons — when to **spend**, when to **hold**, when to **reset**.

Each decision changes your score.

If your combined timing choices hit the right balance — meaning all three teams stay competitive without breaking their future — you'll automatically receive an **email with your claim code** for this lesson:

L1-301-M1 (+50 XP).

No essays, no notes, just decisions — like a real front office.

You'll see right away whether your plan works... or if your window closed early.

(play a soft ticking clock under this section, fading into a calendar-flip sound as you say “plan your next four years.”)

301 M1L3

/🎓 Track 301 · Module 1 · Lesson 3 — The Efficiency Frontier

🎧 Intro (≈1 min)

“Welcome back to Track 301.

By now, you’ve learned to time your payroll window and balance your roster curves.

In this final lesson, we’re going higher-level — into efficiency.

Every GM can spend. The question is: *what’s each dollar worth?*

At some point, money stops buying wins.

The richest teams plateau, the cap tightens, and the only edge left is how efficiently you allocate what you already have.

Today we’ll define and measure that concept — what we call the **Efficiency Frontier**: the point where each additional dollar still produces real competitive value.”

🧠 Part 1 — Diminishing Returns

“In economics, the law of diminishing returns says each extra input gives a smaller output than the one before it.

In sports:

- The first \$50 million turns you from irrelevant to competitive.
- The next \$50 million strengthens depth.
- The last \$50 million just buys headlines.

Every league hits that limit — the point where investment no longer scales with success.

- **MLB:** Payroll and win percentage flatten once clubs hit the 95-win mark.
- **NBA:** Each dollar above the tax line gets penalized — a built-in efficiency ceiling.
- **NFL:** With a hard cap, there’s no room to buy out mistakes — efficiency decides survival.

Smart front offices know when the marginal win isn’t worth the marginal dollar.”

📊 Part 2 — Reading the Frontier

“Picture a graph:

x-axis = Payroll.

y-axis = Wins or value.

At first the curve is steep — spending adds huge value.

Then it bends and flattens.

That bend is the **Efficiency Frontier** — the threshold where spending stops creating proportional return.

Operating below the curve means inefficiency; operating on it means optimization.

The best executives live *right before* the flattening point: spending enough to compete but never so much that dollars stop working.”

Part 3 — League Applications

MLB — Open Market

“With no cap, baseball’s curve is steep early and flat late.

A small-market club can gain big returns from small payroll increases, but superteams often pay enormous sums for marginal improvement.”

NFL — Cap Discipline

“In a hard-cap league, every contract has an opportunity cost.

Value comes from rookie-deal quarterbacks, late-round efficiency, and timing extensions.

Overspend in one spot, and the roster collapses elsewhere.”

NBA — Tax Tiers

“The NBA’s tax apron enforces diminishing returns.

After that threshold, a dollar can cost four in taxes while returning half a win.

The sharpest teams hover right under the apron — efficient, flexible, and still competitive.”

Part 4 — Strategic Takeaway

“Money in sports isn’t just about budgets; it’s about *information*.

Knowing when to stop spending is as powerful as knowing where to start.

Every dollar you allocate has a marginal impact curve — and every league hides its own slope.

The best front offices master that slope, staying at the frontier rather than chasing beyond it.”

Wrap-Up / Tease

“So far in Track 301, you’ve built three analytical muscles:

- **Timing** — when to spend.

- **Balance** — how to distribute it.
- **Efficiency** — how to make each dollar count.

301 M1L2



Track 301 — Module 1, Lesson 2

The Payroll Curve: How Spending Changes Through a Team's Life Cycle

Subtitle: *Timing isn't just when you play — it's how you pay.*



Intro (≈ 1 minute)

“Welcome back to **Track 301**, I'm **Brayden White**, and this is **BOW Sports Capital** — where we break down how real front offices think.

In Lesson 1, we talked about **timing windows** — when to go for it and when to wait. But once that window opens, the next challenge is **how you spend** through it.

Smart teams don't spend evenly.

They shape their payroll like a curve — building up, peaking, then easing back down.

It's the rhythm of a contender: build lean, peak hard, reset smart.

That shape — that slope — is what we call **the payroll curve**.

Today, we'll see how front offices use that curve to stay competitive year after year — and you'll get to design one yourself inside the **Curve Room simulation**.”



Part 1 — The Shape of the Curve

“Every team's payroll tells a story.

If you plotted it on a graph — spending over time — you'd see phases:

- **Build Phase:** low spending, focused on development and flexibility.
- **Peak Phase:** payroll spikes — stars extended, vets added, tax risk climbs.
- **Reset Phase:** spending drops as old deals roll off and value resets.

It's a cycle — **Build** → **Peak** → **Reset** → **Repeat**.

The best front offices control *when* those transitions happen instead of letting the roster force them.

Teams that mistime the slope end up paying superstar prices for an aging roster.”

Part 2 — Different Leagues, Different Shapes

“Each league creates its own version of the curve.”

-  **Baseball – The Long Wave**
Payroll rises slowly as prospects mature, peaks during arbitration and extensions, then resets before those deals get heavy.
-  **Football – The Spike**
You spend aggressively while your QB's on a rookie deal, then pull back fast once that extension hits.
-  **Basketball – The Plateau**
You surge to the tax line, hold that level while stars stay elite, then trim before the payroll drags you under.

“Three sports, three shapes — but the same rule:

Your payroll should move with your roster's life cycle, not against it.”

Part 3 — The Flatline Problem

“What kills teams is flat spending.

If you stay low forever, you never grow.

If you stay maxed out, you lose flexibility.

That middle zone — steady but stagnant — is the **flatline**, where teams get trapped.

The best GMs treat payroll like a pulse: always moving.

Sometimes that means cutting veterans a year early; sometimes it means a short dip to create a future spike.

A healthy payroll curve never sits still.”

Part 4 — Designing the Curve

“Front offices sketch these curves years ahead.

They map contract expirations, tax thresholds, and when their young core gets expensive.

They literally draw out the slope — planning when to spend big and when to reset.

That's how smart teams stay competitive without ever bottoming out.

Their payroll never crashes; it loops smoothly into the next cycle.”

Part 5 — Your Turn: The Curve Room Simulation

“Alright, time to test your instincts inside the **Curve Room**.

You’ll step into three interactive ‘rooms,’ each representing a different sport.

Each room gives you five years of financial data, projected contracts, and roster timelines.

Your goal? **Shape the curve**.

- Decide when to invest heavily.
- Decide when to pull back.
- Keep your team competitive without burning your future.

Every choice moves your line — and your **League Health Meter** will react in real time.

Balance the slope correctly and you’ll earn your claim code:

L2-301-M1-CURVE → +50 XP.

This isn’t about guessing numbers — it’s about *feeling the rhythm* of a team’s life cycle.”

(Optional sound cue: faint pencil-on-graph-paper scribble as you say “draw your curve.”)

Wrap-Up / Tease for Lesson 3

“So now you’ve learned how to plan and shape payroll through a full window — how to keep your team’s pulse healthy.

In the next lesson, we’ll talk about what comes *after* the curve — when the money’s spent, the window’s tight, and you need to squeeze every ounce of value out of what’s left.

That’s where we introduce **the Efficiency Frontier** — our own model for measuring how much winning each dollar really buys.

Because once the spending curve flattens, the only way to stay ahead is to make every dollar count.

I’m **Brayden White**, and this is **BOW Sports Capital** — see you in **Lesson 3**.”

Module 2 301

301 M2L1

Track 301 · Module 2 · Lesson 1 — “The Business of Winning”

Theme:

How different ownership philosophies shape the tension between chasing titles and chasing profits.

Script Outline (≈ 4 min Podcast)

Intro (Hook)

“Every team says it wants to win.
But some act like businesses first — and ballclubs second.
In today’s game, victory isn’t just on the field; it’s on the balance sheet.”

Segment 1 — The Profit Paradox

Every owner faces a trade-off: spend for trophies or save for shareholders.
The Yankees pour cash into stars to drive prestige and global revenue.
Others, like the Rays, build lean, sustainable rosters by investing in analytics and player development.
Then there are teams that slash costs entirely — like the modern Oakland A’s — prioritizing short-term profit over competitive integrity.

Segment 2 — Two Paths to Power

The Performance Model:

Heavy spending, brand dominance, championship risk. High reward, high volatility.

The Sustainability Model:

Strategic efficiency — maximizing wins per dollar through smart scouting and development. Modest reward, but long-term stability.

The problem? When the “sustainability” model turns into **cost-cutting**, fans walk away — and the brand collapses.

Segment 3 — The Scoreboard You Can't See

Championships look priceless — until you read the ledger.

A World Series run can double franchise valuation ... but eat through operating cash.

Meanwhile, a low-spend team may clear profit ... while finishing last.

The real art of ownership is knowing when spending *is* the investment.

Segment 4 — Your Turn

"You own a mid-market team.

Your fans are restless, your investors are cautious.

You can:

- Boost payroll 20 % and chase a title,
 - Hold steady for profit, or
 - Cut spending to 'reset.'
- What's your move — and how do you sell it to the public?"
-

Interactive Challenge — 'Win Curve Simulator'

Objective: Balance success and sustainability across 3 seasons.

Mechanic (Forms-ready):

1. **Pick Your Market:** Big / Mid / Small Market
2. **Set Payroll Each Year** (\$ cap = \$100 M)
3. Each choice adjusts two scores:
 -  **Win Score** (based on spending & momentum)
 -  **Profit Score** (based on market size & expenses)
4. After 3 years, see your outcome:
 -  "Contender" (High Wins + Low Cash)
 -  "Stable Franchise" (Medium Wins + Profit)
 -  "Fan Revolt" (Low Wins + High Profit)

Claim Code: L1-301-M2-WIN

XP: 200

 **Takeaway:**

Winning is an investment decision.

Teams that balance ambition and discipline build dynasties.
Teams that cut corners build empty stadiums.

301 M2 L2

Track 301 · Module 2 · Lesson 2

Risk, Volatility, and Rational Aggression

Subtitle: Winning big and losing smart are not opposites.

INTRO (≈ 1 min)

Alright, welcome back to Track 301.

In the last lesson, we talked about the business of winning — how owners don't just chase championships, they chase value.

Today, we're taking that one step further.

Because once you accept that winning is an investment decision, not a moral one, a new question shows up:

Why do some teams *intentionally* take huge risks...
while others play it safe, even when fans are begging them to go all-in?

Why does one front office get praised for being “bold,”
and another get crushed for being “reckless” —
even when they're doing almost the same thing?

The answer isn't effort.
It's not ambition.
And it's definitely not heart.

It's **risk** — and how systems reward or punish it.

PART 1 — SAME AVERAGE, VERY DIFFERENT TEAMS (≈ 2 min)

Let's start with a simple idea.

Imagine two teams.

Team A wins, on average, 45 games a season.
Team B also wins, on average, 45 games a season.

Same average outcome.

But here's the difference:

Team A almost always finishes between 42 and 48 wins.

Team B is wild — some years they win 60, other years they crash to 30.

Same average.

Completely different experience.

Fans usually prefer Team B.

Owners don't always.

Why?

Because **average outcome is not the whole story**.

What matters is how spread out the outcomes are — how extreme the highs and lows can be.

That spread is called **volatility**.

And volatility changes everything.

PART 2 — WHY “BAD RESULTS” DON’T ALWAYS MEAN “BAD STRATEGY” (≈ 2 min)

Here's where fans and front offices talk past each other.

Fans judge decisions by results:

“You lost — therefore the plan was bad.”

Front offices judge decisions by distributions:

“Was this strategy *likely* to create value?”

A high-risk strategy can fail and still be rational.

A low-risk strategy can succeed and still be weak.

This is why two teams can make nearly identical moves and get treated very differently.

If a small-market team swings big and misses, fans might say:

“At least they tried.”

If a big-market team does the same thing and misses, the reaction is:

“How could they be so irresponsible?”

Same move.

Different system.

PART 3 — RISK IS NOT THE SAME AS BEING DUMB (≈ 2 min)

Here's the key idea most people miss:

Risk is not about being reckless.

Risk is about **how much variation a system can survive**.

Some organizations *need* volatility.

If you're stuck in the middle — not bad enough to rebuild, not good enough to win — playing it safe just locks you there.

In that case, risk isn't dangerous.

It's necessary.

Other organizations can't afford that same volatility.

If your brand depends on consistency...

if your revenue collapses when you lose...

if one bad season triggers massive consequences...

Then the *same* risky move becomes irrational.

Not because it's bold — but because the system punishes failure too harshly.

PART 4 — RATIONAL AGGRESSION (≈ 2 min)

This brings us to what great front offices actually do.

They don't ask:

“Is this risky?”

They ask:

“Can our system absorb this risk?”

Rational aggression means:

- Taking big swings *when failure is survivable*
- Avoiding volatility *when downside is catastrophic*

This is why rebuilding teams draft differently than contenders.
Why small markets chase upside while giants hedge.
Why some franchises tolerate chaos — and others fear it.

Risk is not a personality trait.

It's a **system-level decision**.

WRAP-UP (≈ 1 min)

So here's the takeaway.

Two strategies can look identical on paper.
Two teams can make the same move.

But once you factor in volatility, market context, and long-term consequences, one strategy becomes smart... and the other becomes irresponsible.

Risk isn't about courage.
It's about fit.

And in the next activity, you're going to see exactly how different systems reward — or punish — the same aggressive decision.

I'm Brayden White, and this is BOW Sports Capital.

Let's get into it.

301 M2L3



Track 301 · Module 2 · Lesson 3

Fragility, Optionality, and Asymmetric Risk

Subtitle: The same risk can win championships — or end seasons.



Intro (≈ 1 minute)

Alright — welcome back to Track 301.

So far in this module, we've talked about **ownership incentives**, **risk tolerance**, and how different teams *think* about strategy.

Now we're going one layer deeper.

Because here's something that trips up even smart front offices:

Two teams can make the *exact same move*.

Same contract.

Same trade.

Same level of aggression.

One becomes a contender.

The other collapses for years.

And when that happens, fans usually say things like:

"Bad luck."

"They gambled and it didn't work."

"They overreached."

But that's not actually the real reason.

The real reason is that **risk is not universal**.

Risk only makes sense **inside a system** — and some systems absorb shocks, while others break under them.

Today's lesson is about learning to see that difference.

Part 1 — Fragile Systems vs Absorptive Systems (≈ 2 minutes)

Let's start with a simple idea:

Some teams are **fragile**.

Others are **absorptive**.

A fragile team doesn't fail slowly.

It fails *all at once*.

Think about teams with:

- One superstar carrying the entire roster
- Thin depth
- Tight payrolls
- Fanbases or owners who won't tolerate losing

When something goes wrong — an injury, a bad contract, a missed pick — there's nowhere to hide.

The system snaps.

Now contrast that with an absorptive system.

These teams might:

- Have multiple contributors
- Maintain cap flexibility
- Accept short-term losses
- Keep future options alive

When a move fails, it hurts — but it doesn't end the cycle.

Same mistake.

Different outcome.

The key insight here is this:

Risk doesn't live in the decision.

It lives in the structure *around* the decision.

Part 2 — Asymmetric Risk: Why Upside and Downside Aren't Equal (≈ 2 minutes)

Now let's talk about **asymmetric risk** — without math.

Most people assume risk works like this:

“If it fails, we lose about as much as we could have gained.”

That's almost never true in sports.

Some risks have:

- **Limited upside**
- **Massive downside**

Others have:

- **Contained downside**
- **Open-ended upside**

That difference matters more than how aggressive the move looks.

For example:

- Trading future picks when you're already thin
- Backloading contracts when flexibility is already tight
- Building around a single star with no redundancy

In these cases, the *best-case scenario* might raise your ceiling a little.

But the *worst-case scenario* collapses your entire timeline.

That's asymmetric risk — where the downside outweighs the upside.

Smart front offices don't avoid risk.

They avoid **bad asymmetry**.

Part 3 — Optionality: The Real Competitive Advantage (≈ 2 minutes)

Here's where elite teams separate themselves.

The strongest systems aren't aggressive or conservative.

They're **reversible**.

Optionality means:

- You can pivot if something fails
- You still have choices next season
- One mistake doesn't lock you into a bad path

Think of optionality like exits on a highway.

A team with high optionality has:

- Multiple ways forward
- Time to adjust
- Leverage in negotiations

A team without optionality is forced to double down — even when it knows it shouldn't.

This is why some teams look “boring” on the surface.

They're not playing scared.

They're preserving the ability to change their mind.

And in competitive systems, **the ability to change your mind is power**.

Part 4 — Why Smart People Still Get This Wrong (≈ 1.5 minutes)

Here's the trap almost everyone falls into:

They judge moves by **intent**, not by **payoff shape**.

They say:

“This was a bold move.”

“This showed confidence.”

“This was going for it.”

But intent doesn't matter.

What matters is:

What happens if this *fails*?

Does the system:

- Bend?
- Or break?

Does failure:

- Cost one season?
- Or destroy five?

Most bad decisions don't look reckless in isolation.

They look reckless **only in context**.

And context is exactly what this lesson is training you to recognize.

Part 5 — Strategic Takeaway (≈ 1 minute)

So here's the framework you should be carrying forward:

- Risk is not good or bad
- Aggression is not the goal
- Conservatism is not the goal

The goal is **alignment**.

A move is smart only if:

- The system can absorb failure
- The downside is survivable
- The upside justifies the asymmetry

The best teams don't ask:

"Is this risky?"

They ask:

"Can we survive if this goes wrong?"

That question separates contenders from cautionary tales.

Wrap-Up / Bridge to Activity (≈ 30 seconds)

In the activity that follows, you're not going to be asked:

"What would you do?"

Instead, you'll be asked:

"What kind of system *allows* this?"

You'll evaluate risk **through structure**, not emotion.

And by the end, you should be able to look at any move — in any sport — and say:

"This risk works here."

or

"This risk breaks the system."

That's Track 301 thinking.

Module 3 301

301 M3L2



Track 301 · Module 3 · Lesson 2

Information & Signaling

Subtitle: Negotiations don't move on facts — they move on beliefs.



Intro (≈ 1 minute)

Welcome back to Track 301.

In the last lesson, we talked about structural leverage —
who can walk away,
who has alternatives,
and why those things matter more than talent or fairness.

But here's the problem.

Leverage only works if the other side *knows* you have it.

And in most negotiations,
no one actually knows the full truth.

Today's lesson is about that gap —
the space between reality and belief.

Because negotiations don't move on facts.
They move on what each side *thinks* is true.

That's where information and signaling come in.



Part 1 — Why Perfect Information Would Kill Negotiation (≈ 2 minutes)

Imagine a world where both sides knew everything.

Exact alternatives.
Exact deadlines.
Exact tolerance for walking away.

In that world, negotiations would be short —
and boring.

There would be no leverage games,
no brinkmanship,
no surprises.

Deals would settle instantly at predictable outcomes.

But real negotiations don't work like that.
They work because information is incomplete.

Each side is guessing:
How desperate are they?
Do they really have other options?
Is that deadline real?

That uncertainty is not a flaw.
It's the battlefield.

Part 2 — Signaling: What You Want Them to Believe (≈ 2 minutes)

A signal is anything you do
to shape the other side's beliefs about your position.

It's not a statement of fact.
It's a message.

When a team says:
“We're comfortable walking away,”
they're not just describing reality.

They're trying to create it.

Signals can be:
Public statements
Leaks
Offers

Silence
Timing

Even *inaction* is a signal.

The goal isn't to tell the truth.
The goal is to influence expectations.

Because expectations determine concessions.

Part 3 — Anchors: Why the First Number Matters (≈ 2 minutes)

One of the strongest signals in any negotiation
is the first number.

That number becomes an anchor —
a reference point everything else gets judged against.

Even when both sides know it's aggressive.
Even when it's unrealistic.

The brain doesn't reset easily.

In sports negotiations,
anchors show up as:
Opening contract demands
Early extension offers
Reported "asking prices"

Once that anchor is set,
the rest of the negotiation happens *around* it.

This is why first offers are powerful —
and dangerous.

If your anchor is too aggressive,
you lose credibility.
If it's too soft,
you give away leverage you didn't need to.

Part 4 — Strategic Silence (≈ 2 minutes)

One of the most misunderstood tactics in negotiation is silence.

People assume silence means weakness.
Often, it means the opposite.

Silence forces the other side to guess.
And when people guess,
they tend to assume the worst.

No counteroffer.
No public response.
No urgency.

That absence becomes information.

It suggests:
“We’re not under pressure.”
“We have options.”
“We’re willing to wait.”

Silence works best
when you actually *can* wait.

Which is why signaling and structural leverage
are inseparable.

Part 5 — Fairness Is a Constraint, Not a Rule (≈ 2 minutes)

Here’s where negotiations get messy.

People talk about “fair deals” as if fairness is objective.

It isn’t.

Fairness is a perception —
and perceptions constrain behavior.

A deal can be rational,
efficient,

and still impossible
if it *looks* unfair.

That's why:

Teams leak comparable contracts.
Agents frame demands as “market standard.”
Front offices justify deals publicly.

They're not proving fairness.
They're managing backlash.

Because once a deal violates perceived fairness,
it triggers resistance —
from fans, media, players, and sometimes owners.

That pressure changes the negotiation.

Not because value changed —
but because belief did.

Strategic Takeaway (≈ 1 minute)

So here's the core insight of this lesson:

Leverage is real —
but belief is what activates it.

You don't negotiate against the other side's balance sheet.
You negotiate against their expectations.

Every offer,
every pause,
every leak,
every word —
is shaping what the other side thinks is possible.

Control belief,
and the deal moves.
Lose belief,
and leverage evaporates.



Bridge to Lesson 3 ($\approx$ 30 seconds)

In the next lesson,
we're going to zoom out.

Because even when you win a negotiation —
even when you use leverage and signaling perfectly —
there's a cost that doesn't show up immediately.

Reputation.

Lesson 3 is about the long game.
How today's deal rewrites tomorrow's leverage.
And why some negotiators keep winning —
while others slowly get shut out.

That's next.

I'm Brayden White,
and this is BOW Sports Capital.

301 M3L1



Track 301 · Module 3 · Lesson 1

Structural Leverage

Subtitle: Negotiations aren't won with arguments — they're won with alternatives.



Intro (≈ 1 minute)

Alright — welcome back to Track 301.

So far in this track, we've talked about how front offices think in systems:
how they plan timing,
how they balance risk,
how they design structures that survive failure.

Now we're shifting gears.

Because none of that matters if you can't close a deal.

Fans tend to think negotiations are about numbers.
Who deserves what.
Who's worth how much.
Who "won."

But front offices know something very different.

Negotiations are not about value.
They're about leverage.

Today's lesson is about understanding where leverage actually comes from —
and why it almost never comes from talent alone.



Part 1 — Why the Better Player Doesn't Always Win (≈ 2 minutes)

Let's start with a simple puzzle.

Why does a superstar sometimes take a discount,
while a role player squeezes every last dollar out of a team?

It's not because the role player is more important.
And it's not because the team suddenly forgot how good the star is.

It's because leverage is structural, not emotional.

Leverage doesn't come from how good you are.
It comes from how many options you have.

If one side can walk away,
and the other side can't,
the deal will bend toward the side with alternatives —
every time.

That's the first rule of negotiation:
the side with the better outside option controls the table.

Part 2 — BATNA: The Quiet Power Behind Every Deal **(≈ 2 minutes)**

In economics, there's a term for this.
It's called **BATNA** — your *Best Alternative To a Negotiated Agreement*.

You don't need to memorize the acronym.
You just need to understand the idea.

Ask this question:
“What happens if this deal doesn't get done?”

If the answer is:
“We're fine.”
You have leverage.

If the answer is:
“We're stuck.”
You don't.

In sports, BATNAs show up everywhere.

A player with multiple teams bidding.
A team with cap space and depth.
A front office that can wait until next season.

And the opposite:

A team facing a hard deadline.
A player with no real market.
A situation where walking away causes immediate damage.

Leverage lives in that gap.

Not in what you say —
but in what happens if you say no.

Part 3 — Deadlines Are Leverage Machines (≈ 2 minutes)

Now let's talk about time.

Deadlines are not neutral.
They create pressure.
And pressure shifts leverage.

Think about the difference between:

“We'd like to extend you.”

versus

“We need to extend you before tomorrow.”

Same player.
Same value.
Completely different negotiation.

Why?

Because deadlines compress options.
As time runs out, walking away becomes more costly for one side —
and less costly for the other.

This is why:

Holdouts work.
Last-minute extensions get expensive.
Trade demands heat up near roster deadlines.

It's not drama.
It's math.

When time removes alternatives,
leverage tilts fast.

Part 4 — Replaceability Is the Hidden Variable (≈ 2 minutes)

Here's another truth fans miss.

Leverage is not about how good you are.
It's about how hard you are to replace.

A great player in a deep market
can have less leverage than a solid player in a thin one.

A team negotiating with:
five similar free agents
has options.

A team negotiating with:
one unique fit
does not.

Front offices obsess over this.
Not because they're heartless —
but because replaceability determines bargaining power.

If losing you creates chaos,
you have leverage.
If losing you creates inconvenience,
you don't.

Part 5 — Leverage Is Often Invisible (≈ 2 minutes)

The most important thing to understand is this:

Real leverage rarely gets announced.

No one says:

“We’re desperate.”

No one says:

“We have no alternatives.”

That information stays quiet.

Behind closed doors.

In internal models and contingency plans.

Which is why fans often misread negotiations.

They think:

“The team is being cheap.”

or

“The player is being greedy.”

But what’s actually happening is structural.

One side knows it can wait.

The other side knows it can’t.

And once you see that,

the outcome becomes predictable.

Strategic Takeaway (≈ 1 minute)

So here’s the framework you should walk away with:

Negotiations are not debates.

They’re not moral judgments.

They’re not popularity contests.

They are contests of alternatives.

Before you ask:

“What should this deal look like?”

You should ask:

“Who can afford to say no?”

Because the side that can walk away

doesn’t need to convince.

They just need to wait.

Bridge to Lesson 2 (≈ 30 seconds)

In the next lesson, we're going to build on this foundation.

Because once you understand where leverage comes from,
the next question is:

How do you *shape what the other side believes* about your leverage?

That's where information, signaling,
and strategic silence come in.

Structural power gets you to the table.
Belief control decides the terms.

That's Lesson 2.

I'm Brayden White,
and this is BOW Sports Capital.

301 M3L3



Track 301 · Module 3 · Lesson 3

Reputation & the Long Game

Subtitle: Every deal changes the next one.



Intro (≈ 1 minute)

Welcome back to Track 301.

In the last two lessons, we broke negotiation down into its mechanics.

First, we looked at **structural leverage** —
who can walk away and who can't.

Then we looked at **information and signaling** —
how beliefs move deals more than facts.

Today's lesson is different.

Because even if you understand leverage,
and even if you control perception,
there's still a question that never shows up on the term sheet:

What does this deal do to your future power?

That's what reputation is.
And in high-level negotiations,
reputation is currency.



Part 1 — Negotiation Is a Repeated Game (≈ 2 minutes)

Most people treat negotiations as isolated events.

One deal.

One outcome.

One winner.

Front offices don't.

They know that almost every negotiation is part of a repeated game.

The same agents.

The same teams.

The same decision-makers —
again and again.

That changes everything.

In a repeated game,
winning too hard today
can make tomorrow worse.

Because the other side remembers.

And memory shapes future behavior.

Part 2 — Reputation as Economic Capital (≈ 2 minutes)

Reputation isn't about being "nice."
It's about being predictable.

If a team is known to:
move goalposts
leak selectively
or exploit desperation

Other negotiators adapt.

They demand more up front.
They shorten timelines.
They avoid engagement entirely.

The same is true for agents and players.

Someone labeled "difficult" doesn't lose leverage —
but they do lose access.

And access is power.

In high-level negotiations,
being trusted enough to get the *first call*
is often more valuable than squeezing the last dollar.

Part 3 — Credible Threats vs Empty Ones (≈ 2 minutes)

Reputation determines which threats are believed.

Anyone can say:
“We’ll walk away.”

But only some negotiators get taken seriously.

Why?

Because credibility is built through follow-through.

If you bluff and fold,
your leverage shrinks next time.
If you follow through once,
people remember.

That doesn’t mean you should always be rigid.
It means that when you draw a line,
you need to be willing to live with it.

Reputation is the accumulation of those moments.

Part 4 — The Cost of Winning Too Much (≈ 2 minutes)

Here’s the trap elite negotiators avoid.

If you maximize value in every single deal,
you eventually stop getting invited to negotiate.

People hedge against you.
They protect themselves.
They stop sharing information.

You still get deals —
but worse ones,
with less flexibility,
and more friction.

That's why the best negotiators don't always extract everything.

They leave room.
They preserve relationships.
They think in sequences, not snapshots.

This isn't altruism.
It's strategy.

Part 5 — Strategic Consistency (≈ 2 minutes)

The strongest reputations are not aggressive or soft.
They're consistent.

Other parties know:
where you'll push
where you won't
and when you're serious

That consistency reduces noise.
It shortens negotiations.
It increases trust.

In economic terms,
it lowers transaction costs.

In practical terms,
it makes future deals easier.

That's real leverage —
earned slowly,
but incredibly hard to replicate.

Strategic Takeaway (≈ 1 minute)

Here's the final framework of this module:

Leverage gets you options.
Information moves the deal.
Reputation decides how often you get invited back.

Negotiation power is not about domination.
It's about sustainability.

The people who win long careers in this space
aren't the loudest or toughest.
They're the ones others want — or need — to deal with.

Module Wrap-Up (≈ 30 seconds)

So in Module 3, you've learned three layers of negotiation power:

Structural leverage — who can say no.
Information and signaling — what others believe.
Reputation — how today shapes tomorrow.

If you can read all three at once,
you're no longer reacting.
You're controlling the table.

That's Track 301 thinking.

I'm Brayden White,
and this is BOW Sports Capital.

Module 4 301

301 M4L1



Track 301 · Module 4 · Lesson 1

Models Are Maps, Not Reality

Subtitle: Why the smartest front offices still get surprised.



Intro (≈ 1 minute)

Welcome back to Track 301.

If you've made it to Module 4, you already know how to think in systems.

You understand leverage.

You understand incentives.

You understand negotiation power.

Now we're going to talk about the most dangerous tool in decision-making:
the model.

Because models feel objective.

They feel scientific.

They feel safe.

And that's exactly why they can mislead even the smartest organizations in sports.

Today's lesson is about learning to respect models without worshipping them —
and understanding why every model, no matter how sophisticated, is incomplete.



Part 1 — Why Models Exist (≈ 3 minutes)

Let's start with the obvious question:

Why do teams use models at all?

Because reality is too complex to process raw.

A front office is juggling:

player performance,

injury risk,

contract structure,
league rules,
market pressure,
and future uncertainty.

You cannot reason about all of that intuitively.

So teams build models.

A payroll model reduces thousands of financial interactions into a curve.
A projection model compresses years of performance into a single expected value.
A draft model turns chaos into rankings.

Models are not meant to be reality.
They are meant to be **usable**.

And that usability comes from simplification.

Which means something always gets cut.

Part 2 — What Models *A/ways* Leave Out (≈ 3 minutes)

Every model makes assumptions.
Even when those assumptions aren't written down.

Most sports models quietly assume things like:

- linear improvement
- stable health
- predictable usage
- rational behavior

Those assumptions are not stupid.
They are necessary.

But they are also fragile.

A model that assumes health collapses when injuries cluster.
A model that assumes rational behavior breaks when ego enters the room.
A model that assumes linear growth fails when development jumps — or stalls.

The danger is not the assumption.
The danger is forgetting it's there.

Part 3 — When the Model Works (≈ 3 minutes)

Let's be clear: models *do* work — often brilliantly.

Think about the rise of the analytics-driven NBA.

Teams like the **Golden State Warriors** used shot-value models to prioritize spacing, ball movement, and three-point volume.

Those models correctly identified inefficiencies in mid-range shooting.
They reshaped how basketball is played.

In baseball, the **Oakland Athletics** used value-per-dollar models to compete despite payroll constraints.

They didn't find better players.
They found better prices.

These are real successes.

And they happened *because* the models captured the right simplifications.

The map worked — because the terrain was stable.

Part 4 — When the Model Breaks (≈ 4 minutes)

Now let's look at when the map stops matching the territory.

A famous modern example is the **Houston Rockets** during their extreme three-point optimization era.

The model was sound:

three-point shots have higher expected value than mid-range shots.
Spacing increases efficiency.
Variance favors underdogs.

All true.

But what did the model struggle to capture?

- playoff defenses adapting
- fatigue over long series
- the psychological cost of missing 27 straight threes

The model didn't *fail* mathematically.
It failed contextually.

It assumed the environment would remain static.
It didn't.

Another example:
the **Brooklyn Nets** and superstar aggregation.

Models said:
elite talent raises championship probability.
Stars drive wins and revenue.

Also true.

But the models underestimated:

- availability risk
- chemistry volatility
- governance complexity

The assumptions held individually.
They broke collectively.

Part 5 — Precision Is Not Accuracy (≈ 3 minutes)

Here's the most dangerous moment in modeling:
when the output looks precise.

A projection that says:
"48.7 wins"
feels smarter than one that says:
"mid-40s."

But that decimal doesn't represent knowledge.
It represents confidence.

False confidence.

In sports, precision often comes from overfitting —
models tuned so tightly to past data that they mistake noise for signal.

They explain yesterday perfectly.
And fail tomorrow.

The cleaner the output,
the more tempted executives are to stop questioning it.

That's when models stop being tools
and start becoming excuses.

Part 6 — Executive Judgment Lives *Outside* the Model **(≈ 3 minutes)**

Elite front offices don't abandon models.
They contextualize them.

They ask:

- What would have to be true for this model to be wrong?
- What variables are we assuming away?
- Where does human behavior matter more than math?

They treat models as *inputs* —
not verdicts.

And when reality starts diverging from the map,
they don't double down blindly.
They reassess the terrain.

That's not anti-analytics.
That's mastery.

Strategic Takeaway (≈ 1 minute)

So here's the core insight of Lesson 1:

Models are not reality.

They are compressed stories about reality.

Their power comes from simplification.

Their danger comes from forgetting what was simplified away.

The best decision-makers don't ask:

"What does the model say?"

They ask:

"What does the model *assume* —
and do I still believe that?"

Bridge to Lesson 2 (≈ 30 seconds)

In the next lesson, we're going to push this further.

Because once you understand that models are incomplete,
a harder question appears:

What happens when **two good models disagree**?

Which one do you trust?

And why?

That's Lesson 2:

Competing Models, Competing Answers.

I'm Brayden White,

and this is BOW Sports Capital.

301 M4L2



Track 301 · Module 4 · Lesson 2

Competing Models, Competing Answers

Subtitle: Why smart frameworks disagree — and why choosing is the real skill.



Intro (≈ 1 minute)

Welcome back to Track 301.

In the last lesson, we established something uncomfortable but essential:
models are not reality.

They're simplified representations of it.

Today, we're going one step further.

Because even when models are *well-built*,
even when they're backed by data,
even when they're run by smart people —

they can still disagree.

And when that happens,
there is no spreadsheet that tells you what to do next.

This lesson is about learning how executives choose between models —
and why that choice is often more important than the output itself.



Part 1 — Why Models Disagree (≈ 3 minutes)

At a basic level, models disagree for three reasons:

First: **different assumptions.**

Second: **different objectives.**

Third: **different definitions of success.**

Two models can look at the same roster,
the same payroll,
the same data —
and recommend opposite strategies.

Not because one is wrong,
but because they are answering different questions.

One might be optimizing for:
maximum upside.

Another for:
minimum downside.

Another for:
long-term stability.

The disagreement is not a bug.
It's a signal.

Part 2 — The Same Team, Two Rational Paths (≈ 4 minutes)

Let's ground this with a real front-office dilemma.

Think about the **Philadelphia 76ers** during the Joel Embiid era.

One internal model says:
“We have an MVP-level player in his prime.
Championship probability is highest if we push aggressively now.”

Another model says:
“This player has durability risk.
If we mortgage flexibility and miss, we lose the entire cycle.”

Same data.
Same star.
Two models.
Two rational conclusions.

Neither model is “lying.”
They are optimizing for different outcomes.

And at some point,
someone has to decide which outcome they care about more.

That decision is *not* mathematical.
It's strategic.

Part 3 — Assumptions Are Value Judgments ($\approx$ 3 minutes)

Here's the part most people miss.

Assumptions are not neutral.

When a model assumes:
"Health will remain stable,"
it is embedding optimism.

When a model assumes:
"Future flexibility is valuable,"
it is embedding caution.

When a model discounts long-term outcomes,
it is embedding urgency.

That means every model carries values —
even when it pretends not to.

This is why executives argue about models.
They're not fighting over math.
They're fighting over priorities.

Part 4 — When Model Choice Becomes Power ($\approx$ 4 minutes)

Now let's look at how model choice becomes *leverage*.

Consider the **Los Angeles Dodgers**.

One model says:
"Maximize wins every season; revenue and talent attraction will follow."

Another says:

“Protect long-term depth; avoid catastrophic downside.”

The Dodgers don’t pick one.

They rotate.

They selectively apply models depending on context —
sometimes acting aggressively,
sometimes absorbing short-term inefficiency to preserve optionality.

The power isn’t the model.

It’s knowing **which model to deploy, when.**

Contrast that with teams that rigidly commit to one framework.

They don’t fail because their model is bad.

They fail because the world changes —
and they don’t.

Part 5 — The Executive Question Is Not “Which Is Correct?” (≈ 3 minutes)

Here’s the most important shift students need to make.

The executive question is not:

“Which model is right?”

It’s:

“What would have to be true for this model to be the wrong guide *right now?*”

That reframes the decision.

Instead of defending a framework,
you interrogate its fit.

You ask:

- What risks does this model ignore?
- What outcomes does it overweight?
- What happens if the assumption breaks?

Choosing a model is choosing a lens.

And lenses distort as much as they clarify.

Part 6 — When Disagreement Is a Warning, Not a Problem (≈ 3 minutes)

When two strong models disagree,
that's not paralysis.

That's a warning sign.

It tells you:
the decision is sensitive.
small changes matter.
uncertainty is high.

In those moments,
elite decision-makers don't rush to resolution.

They slow down.
They scenario-test.
They widen the margin for error.

They treat disagreement as information —
not as failure.

Strategic Takeaway (≈ 1 minute)

So here's the core insight of Lesson 2:

Models don't give answers.
They frame choices.

When models disagree,
you are not being asked to compute harder.
You are being asked to decide what you value —
and what you're willing to live with if you're wrong.

That is the difference between analysis and judgment.



Bridge to Lesson 3 ($\approx$ 30 seconds)

In the final lesson of Track 301,
we're going to confront the most dangerous moment in modeling.

The moment when a model feels *so precise*,
so confident,
so clean —
that it shuts down doubt.

Lesson 3 is about **model risk and false confidence**.
Why precision seduces smart people,
and how executives protect themselves from their own frameworks.

That's next.

I'm Brayden White,
and this is BOW Sports Capital.

301 M4L3



Track 301 · Module 4 · Lesson 3

Model Risk & False Confidence

Subtitle: When the numbers stop thinking for you.



Intro (≈ 1 minute)

Welcome back to Track 301.

In Lesson 1, we talked about why models exist — and why they are always incomplete.
In Lesson 2, we explored what happens when good models disagree — and why choosing between them is a value judgment, not a calculation.

Today is the final step.

Because the most dangerous moment in modeling doesn't come from disagreement.
It comes from agreement.

When the model looks clean.
When the output feels precise.
When everyone in the room nods and says,
“the numbers are clear.”

That's when judgment quietly shuts off.

This lesson is about learning to recognize that moment — and resist it.



Part 1 — Precision Feels Like Truth (≈ 3 minutes)

Human brains love precision.

“Between 44 and 48 wins” feels uncertain.
“46.3 wins” feels informed.

But that decimal point doesn't mean the model knows more.
It means the model is **pretending** to know more.

Precision is not accuracy.

Precision is confidence in the *output*, not correctness of the *assumptions*.

And in sports, that difference matters more than almost anywhere else.

Because the systems we're modeling are unstable:

- injuries
- human behavior
- incentives
- randomness

The cleaner the number looks, the more tempted executives are to stop questioning it.

Part 2 — When Models Explain the Past Too Well (≈ 4 minutes)

One of the biggest red flags in modeling is **overfitting**.

That's when a model is tuned so perfectly to historical data that it explains yesterday flawlessly — and tomorrow terribly.

A classic sports example comes from analytics-heavy player valuation models that dominated parts of the early 2010s.

Teams built models that could:

- perfectly back-test past performance
- explain draft success retrospectively
- justify past decisions with near-perfect logic

The problem?

Those models assumed the future would look like the past.

Then the environment changed:

- pace shifted
- skill profiles evolved
- player development pipelines changed

Suddenly, the model's confidence was no longer insight — it was inertia.

Part 3 — When the Spreadsheet Becomes the Decision (≈ 4 minutes)

Here's a subtle but critical shift that happens inside organizations.

At first, the model is a tool:

“Here's what the numbers suggest.”

Then it becomes a justification:

“This is what the model says.”

Eventually, it becomes authority:

“We can't argue with the model.”

That's when responsibility quietly moves from people to spreadsheets.

Executives stop asking:

“What do we believe?”

And start saying:

“The model decided.”

That's not analytics.

That's abdication.

Part 4 — Real-World Consequences of False Confidence (≈ 5 minutes)

Let's look at a few concrete examples.

Example 1 — The Cleveland Browns and Quarterback Certainty

At multiple points in recent history, internal evaluations and models concluded:

“This quarterback profile works in our system.”

The confidence wasn't irrational.

It was over-specific.

The models:

- assumed health
- assumed scheme stability
- assumed linear improvement

What they couldn't model well:

- organizational pressure
- coaching turnover
- psychological response to failure

The problem wasn't data.

It was certainty.

Example 2 — The New York Mets and Aging-Curve Optimism

High-end projection models said:

"These contracts are expensive, but the downside is manageable."

The numbers worked — under assumptions of:

- gradual decline
- availability
- stable performance environments

Reality introduced:

- abrupt injury collapse
- non-linear aging
- cascading roster effects

Again: the model wasn't stupid.

It was confident in assumptions that broke simultaneously.

Example 3 — The Los Angeles Lakers and Star Aggregation

Models showed:

elite talent raises championship probability.

True.

What they underestimated:

- fit costs
- role compression
- volatility from dependency on availability

The failure wasn't believing in stars.

It was believing the output more than the uncertainty around it.

Part 5 — How Elite Decision-Makers Protect Themselves (≈ 4 minutes)

The best front offices do *not* eliminate model risk.

They manage it.

They do a few things consistently:

1. **They stress-test assumptions**
 - What if health fails?
 - What if incentives change?
 - What if behavior isn't rational?
2. **They widen error bars**
 - They treat projections as ranges, not points.
 - They plan for miss scenarios, not just base cases.
3. **They separate confidence from commitment**
 - High confidence doesn't mean all-in.
 - Low confidence doesn't mean inaction.

Most importantly:

they keep *humans* accountable.

The model informs the decision.

It does not make it.

Part 6 — The Executive Skill You're Building (≈ 3 minutes)

By the end of Track 301, you should be able to hear someone say:

"The model says this is the right move."

And immediately ask:

- Based on which assumptions?
- With what margin for error?
- And what happens if it's wrong?

That reflex — skepticism without cynicism — is executive-level thinking.

It's not anti-analytics.

It's anti-blindness.

Final Strategic Takeaway (≈ 1 minute)

Here's the closing insight of Track 301:

Models are powerful because they simplify.
They are dangerous because they convince.

Mastery is not about building better spreadsheets.
It's about knowing when the spreadsheet has gone too quiet.

When doubt disappears,
risk is highest.

The best decision-makers never eliminate uncertainty.
They respect it.

Track 301 Wrap-Up (≈ 30 seconds)

Across Track 301, you've learned to think like an executive:

- You've learned how systems shape outcomes
- How leverage and negotiation work beneath the surface
- How models guide decisions — and how they fail

If you can do one thing after this track, it's this:

Never confuse confidence with correctness.

I'm Brayden White.

And this is BOW Sports Capital.

BUILD A MODEL

<https://braydenokley13-ux.github.io/scout-model/>

201

Module 1 201

Module 1 Lesson 3 201

M1L3201

Intro

“Hey everyone, it’s **Brayden White**, and welcome back to **BOW Sports Capital** — the show where we turn sports business into something you can actually understand. If you’ve been following along through **Track 201**, you’ve already learned how teams manage payrolls, balance their budgets, and juggle the constant push-and-pull between stars and depth.

Today, we’re closing out **Module 1** with one of the most important new rules shaping the NBA right now — a rule that’s changing how every front office thinks: **the Second Apron.**”

Hook

“So, picture this: you’re the GM. You’ve got All-Stars, a deep bench, and a coach you trust. You just need one more guy to make the championship run.

You walk into the office, call your top assistant, and say, ‘Let’s make a trade.’ And they look back at you and go, ‘We can’t. We’re over the Second Apron.’

Wait — what apron? What kitchen are we in?
And why is this one rule suddenly wrecking every deal you try to make?
Let’s break it down.”

Part 1 — What Is the Second Apron (Explained Fast)

“The NBA already had a **salary cap** and a **luxury tax** — that’s nothing new. But now there’s a third level: the **Second Apron**.

Think of it like this:

- The **salary cap** is your spending guideline.
- The **tax line** is where you start paying a fine.
- The **First Apron** is a soft penalty zone.
- And the **Second Apron**? That’s the hard mode — the ‘you messed up’ zone.

Once you cross that line, the league basically says,
‘You can overspend if you want ... but we’re taking away your tools.’

That means:

- You **can't take back more salary** in trades than you send out.
- You **can't use the mid-level exception**.
- You **can't do sign-and-trades**.
- And if you stay over for too long, your **draft picks get frozen**.

It's like cap jail — and your lawyer just told you there's no parole.”

Part 2 — Real Example: The Warriors

“Let's talk about the ultimate test case: **the Golden State Warriors**.

They drafted Steph, Klay, and Draymond. They built a dynasty, then spent huge to keep it together.

But that loyalty came with a price — they've been stuck deep in the Second Apron.

The result?

- They couldn't get creative with trades.
- They couldn't replace role players when guys left.
- They couldn't take risks.

Their flexibility vanished.

In 2024, they were still expensive ... but no longer deep.

That's the real trade-off of the Apron:

Do you **pay your stars** and sacrifice flexibility?

Or do you **balance your roster** and keep your options open?

It's like buying three Lamborghinis — and realizing you can't afford gas or tires.”

Part 3 — Why It Matters

“The Second Apron isn't just an accounting line.

It's a philosophy check.

It forces teams to decide what kind of organization they want to be.

Are you going to buy short-term wins — or build a model that can last?

Every front office has to think long-term now.

The days of fixing problems with one more signing or sneaky trade? Gone.

The Second Apron punishes impatience — and rewards planning.”

Wrap-Up / Takeaway

“So that’s it — the Second Apron: the NBA’s way of telling teams, ‘Flexibility beats firepower.’

You can have the best stars in the world,
but if you can’t maneuver, adjust, or build around them,
you’re stuck watching other teams pass you by.

That wraps up **Module 1 of Track 201**, where we’ve explored how teams manage payrolls, handle tradeoffs, and balance risk against reward.

Next up: **Module 2 — Money in Motion**.

We’ll dig into cash flows, franchise valuations, and how real money moves through the sports business world.

Until then, I’m **Brayden White** — thanks for listening to **BOW Sports Capital**.
Keep learning, keep thinking like a GM, and I’ll see you in Module 2.”

Module 1 Lesson 2(201& 101)

Track 101 — Lesson 2: Luxury Tax Basics

 Episode Title: “What Happens If You Overspend?”

Intro

“Every sport has a limit — a line that separates smart spending from reckless gambling.

In the NBA, that line is called the *luxury tax*.

It’s the league’s way of saying: ‘Sure, you can buy more talent — but you’ll pay for it.’”

Part 1 — What the Luxury Tax Actually Is

“The NBA’s luxury tax is a surcharge — basically a fine — on any team whose payroll rises above a certain threshold.

It’s not a hard cap. Teams can go over it, but every extra dollar gets taxed. And the further you go over, the more you pay.”

“The league divides the tax into **brackets**.

- Go \$0–\$5 million over? You owe \$1.50 for every extra dollar.
- \$5–10 million over? It jumps to \$1.75.
- \$15–20 million over? Now you’re paying \$3.25 per dollar.
And that’s just for teams who’ve been behaving the past few years.”

“If you’ve been taxed in three of the last four seasons, you become a **repeat offender**.

Then the rate skyrockets — \$2.50, \$2.75, \$4.25 per dollar.

At that point, every small raise feels like a punishment for ambition.”

Part 2 — Why the Tax Exists

“This isn’t just about money. It’s about balance.

The league doesn’t want a world where big-market teams — the Lakers, Warriors,

Knicks — can hoard every star just because they print cash.
So the luxury tax levels the playing field.
Half of all tax money goes back to the teams that stay under the line.
That means a small-market team like Indiana actually gets paid for being disciplined.”

“It’s basically a mini economy. Big spenders fund the underdogs.
Owners have to choose between chasing titles or cash rebates.”

Part 3 — Real-World Impact

“Let’s see how it plays out.
The Golden State Warriors in 2023 spent around \$300 million on player salaries.
After taxes, that ballooned to almost \$480 million. That’s a \$180 million penalty for keeping Steph, Klay, and Draymond together.
But it bought them four rings and a decade of relevance.”

“Meanwhile, the New York Mets spent \$440 million and didn’t even make the playoffs.
They paid the price for bad timing and worse roster construction.
That’s the luxury tax lesson: Money can buy players — not chemistry.”

Part 4 — The Psychology of Spending

“The tax forces every GM to answer one question:
How much is winning worth to me — and to my owner?
Do I keep a fan-favorite who’s overpaid? Do I risk the locker room to save \$5 million?
It’s numbers meets nerves.
Because every dollar isn’t just accounting — it’s culture, trust, and pressure.”

Wrap-Up / Challenge Prompt

“Now you get to make the calls.
In the ‘Spend or Save?’ challenge, you’ll face the same decisions real front offices do: Add talent, save money, or trade your way out of trouble.
Each choice changes your team’s future — and your XP.
So load up the activity slides, make your moves, and see if you can stay under the line.”

Track 201 — Lesson 2 MOdule 1



“Luxury Tax, Explained Fast”

Teams can spend. But past a point, every extra dollar gets expensive.

That point is the **NBA luxury tax** — a surcharge on payroll **above** the tax line.

Think of it like stairs that get steeper the higher you climb. Only the dollars **over the line** are taxed, and they're taxed in brackets — an **escalator**.

Non-repeaters:

- **\$0–\$5M over → \$1.50 per \$1**
- **\$5–\$10M → \$1.75 per \$1**
- **\$10–\$15M → \$2.50 per \$1**
- **\$15M+ → \$3.25 per \$1**

Repeaters (*taxed in 3 of the last 4 seasons*):

- **\$0–\$5M → \$2.50 • \$5–\$10M → \$2.75 • \$10–\$15M → \$3.50 • \$15M+ → \$4.25**

Quick example: If you're **\$13M** over as a **non-repeater**, tax = $5 \times 1.50 + 5 \times 1.75 + 3 \times 2.50$
= **\$23.75M**.

Your **total spend** = **payroll + tax** — that's what ownership actually feels.

Why it exists: not to stop ambition, but to **price it**. It discourages hoarding, rewards discipline, and forces the question: *What does the **next dollar** buy?* Timing matters: a tiny raise can bump you into a **higher bracket**; a tiny savings can drop you **down a bracket**, lowering both **the rate** and **the taxed dollars**.

Two real-world lessons:

- **Golden State Warriors**   — Massive payroll to keep a homegrown core. After tax, the bill swelled toward **~\$480M** in a peak year — but it powered a dynasty. When spending buys **high-leverage playoff minutes**, the tax can be a weapon.

- **New York Mets**  — Enormous outlay (about ~\$440M in one season) without results. Big money, mismatched pieces, no payoff. The tax (or MLB's equivalent penalties) won't buy **chemistry** or **fit**.

The luxury tax isn't a villain; it's a **mirror**. With a clear plan and cohesive roster, paying tax can be the cost of staying great. With a messy plan, the tax punishes you twice — on the court and on the books.

Your Turn — Owner Risk Meter (interactive)

Open the simulation and **play GM**:

- Pick a **Scenario**, then choose **2–5 Moves** (*Category* → *Move*).
- Hit all three: **Target Wins**, **Target Spend** ($\leq$), **Target Performance Points** (*Reg* $Wt \times Wins + PO$ $Wt \times PO$ Wins + 50/60 bonuses).
- **No coasting**: make **at least one** move (add wins **or** cut spend).
- When **Results = CLEARED**, your **Claim Code** appears: **L2-201-M1-XXX** → **+50 XP**.

Module 1 Lesson 1(201)



Episode Script — Module 1 Lesson 1(201): How Teams Bend the Cap

Lesson 1: Exceptions, Loopholes, and Workarounds Across Leagues

Hook

“Salary caps sound simple: a limit on how much a team can spend. But in reality, front offices treat the rules like puzzles to solve. Whether it’s the NBA, NFL, or MLB, winning often comes down to who knows the *loopholes*. Today, we’ll dig into the tricks — Bird Rights, void years, luxury tax dodges — and why they matter.”

Part 1 — NBA (Soft Cap = Exceptions Everywhere)

- **Bird Rights:** Named after Larry Bird. If you drafted or traded for a player and keep them, you can re-sign them even if you’re over the cap.
 - *Example:* The Warriors re-signed Steph Curry, Klay Thompson, and Draymond Green using Bird Rights, even though they were way over the cap. That’s how dynasties stick together.
- **Mid-Level Exception:** Lets over-the-cap teams sign a free agent for about \$12M.
 - *Example:* The Warriors added Donte DiVincenzo in 2022 with the mid-level. Without it, they’d only have minimum deals.
- **Vet Minimum Exception:** No matter how capped out you are, you can always add veterans on minimum salaries.
 - *Example:* The Lakers filled their 2020 title roster with key vets like Rajon Rondo and Dwight Howard on minimum deals.



Stat: In 2024, *over 70% of NBA contracts* were signed using exceptions, not cap space. That means exceptions aren’t a loophole — they’re the real system.

Part 2 — NFL (Hard Cap = Contract Engineering)

- NFL cap has *no exceptions* — but teams create flexibility with **contracts**.
- **Signing Bonuses:** Instead of paying a salary all at once, teams give a big upfront bonus and spread the cap hit over years.

- *Example:* Patrick Mahomes's deal had a \$10M signing bonus, but only \$2M counted against the 2020 cap because it was spread across five years.
- **Void Years:** Teams add "fake" years at the end of a contract to stretch out the cap hit, even though the player won't actually play those years.
 - *Example:* The Saints gave Taysom Hill a deal with \$140M in "void years" in 2021. Those years automatically disappeared later, but they gave the Saints temporary breathing room under the cap.

 **Stat:** In 2023, over 40% of NFL players were on minimum contracts. Why? Because all that money has to fit under one hard number — and bonuses/void tricks are how GMs squeeze in stars.

Part 3 — MLB (No Cap, But a Tax Ceiling)

- MLB has *no salary cap*. Teams can spend whatever they want.
- The only limit: the **Competitive Balance Tax** (luxury tax).
- **How it works:** If a team's payroll goes over \$237M (2024 threshold), every extra dollar is taxed — at higher and higher rates for repeat offenders.
 - *Example:* The Mets in 2023 had a \$343M payroll. With tax penalties, the final bill was \$443M — more than the Oakland A's franchise was worth at the time.
- Strategy: Big-market teams (Dodgers, Yankees) often shrug and pay. Small-market teams (Rays, Guardians) avoid crossing the line and build competitive rosters with efficiency instead.

 **Stat:** The Rays reached the 2020 World Series with a payroll under \$30M — *less than 10%* of the Mets' payroll in 2023.

Wrap-Up / Takeaway

"So here's the big picture:

- **NBA:** Loopholes like Bird Rights and exceptions let teams keep stars and reload.
- **NFL:** With no exceptions, teams bend contracts instead — using bonuses and void years to stay under the cap.
- **MLB:** There's no cap at all, but the luxury tax pushes small teams toward efficiency and rich teams toward massive spending.

Different rules, different tricks — but in every league, the real winners are the front offices who know how to bend the system without breaking it."

Now that you know the tricks, it's your turn to try them. In today's Cap Crash Challenge, you'll be the GM of an NBA team. Your job: build a legal roster under the cap while keeping your stars. You'll need to use Bird Rights, the Mid-Level Exception, and the Vet Minimum just like the pros do.

To start, fill out the quick form linked at the bottom of this episode description — once you do, the Cap Crash sheet will be sent right to you. Just put your email address so you will be in the system to start earning xp.

When you're done, check the status on your roster. If it turns green and says '**YES**', you've cracked the puzzle. At the bottom of the sheet, you'll find your **Claim Code** — enter that in the finish form to prove you completed the challenge and unlock the next lesson."

Module 2 201

Module 2 Lesson 1

Podcast Script — “The League as a Business” - Module 2 Lesson 1 201

[Intro music fades in]

HOST:

Every time you watch a game, there's a second scoreboard running in the background—the one for money.

Because the NBA, the NFL, the MLB... they aren't just sports leagues.

They're billion-dollar joint ventures.

And the real power move isn't just winning a championship.

It's winning the *next TV deal*.

[Beat]

Let's break down how leagues actually function when you zoom out from the field and into the boardroom.

Segment 1 — The League's Business Model

Think of a league as a giant co-owned corporation.

Every team is a franchise.

Every player contract is basically a financial asset on the company's books.

The league goes out and sells things that belong to *everyone*—national broadcast rights, streaming packages, brand sponsorships, official partnerships.

Then it redistributes that money back to the teams through revenue sharing.

And here's where things get interesting.

Some leagues, like the NFL, share revenue almost evenly.

Others—like MLB—share much less.

That one difference shapes everything.

It affects how much teams can spend, how competitive small markets can be, and even which free agents get paid.

Segment 2 — The Power of Media Deals

Here's a fun one:

When the NBA signed its last national TV contract, the salary cap jumped by twenty-four million dollars *in one year*.

And that wasn't luck.

That was math.

Media rights feed directly into league revenue.

League revenue drives the salary cap.

The cap controls payroll.

And payroll determines what your roster can look like.

So when a new media deal hits, the entire ecosystem shifts.

Star contracts explode.

Teams rethink their strategies.

And suddenly, the league's financial landscape looks totally different than it did the year before.

Segment 3 — CBA Basics

All of this runs through the CBA—the Collective Bargaining Agreement.

This is where the league and the players decide how to split the money.

In most leagues, players get roughly half of what's called "basketball-related income" or its equivalent.

So if a league inks a ten-billion-dollar TV deal?

About five billion of that ends up flowing back into player salaries.

Understanding that split is the cheat code to reading any sports-business headline.

It explains why salaries rise, why caps expand, and why teams behave the way they do.

Segment 4 — Your Turn

Now it's on you.

A new streaming platform wants exclusive rights to your league for eight years.

They're willing to pay eight billion dollars.

Your job is to step into the league office and figure out what happens next.

How much does the cap rise?

How does the new money get shared?

And does this deal create competitive balance... or widen the gap between big and small markets?

Welcome to the real side of sports finance—where leagues aren't just entertainment.
They're economic systems.

Closing

Team budgets don't exist on an island.
They live inside a complex league economy.
And one broadcast contract can reshape an entire generation of players, executives, and franchises.

If you truly want to understand sports...
you have to understand *how the money moves*.

[Outro music fades out]

Module 2 Lesson 2

BOW Sports Capital — Track 201 | Module 2 | Lesson 2

“Player Economics: Contracts, Agents, Incentives, and Guarantees”

Full Podcast Script (≈ 7–9 minutes)

INTRO (00:00–00:40)

HOST (Brayden):

"Hey everyone, it's Brayden White — welcome back to BOW Sports Capital, where we break down the business of sports one deal at a time.

In our last lesson, we talked about *league health* and how money moves between teams. But today, we're zooming in.

Because behind every superstar contract, there's an equation — not just of dollars and years, but of *risk*, *incentives*, and *negotiation strategy*.

This is **Player Economics** — and by the end of this episode, you'll know exactly how agents think when they say...

'We're betting on ourselves.'"

HOOK (00:40–01:15)

"Imagine you're an agent.

Your client? A rising star — breakout season, endorsement potential, everyone's watching.

The team puts an offer on the table:

4 years, \$80 million guaranteed.

But your gut says if he plays out one more season, he could be worth *double* that.

So what do you do?

Do you take the security now... or gamble on the future?

Every contract is a game of poker — and both sides think they're holding the better hand."

PART 1 — The Basics of a Deal (01:15–03:00)

“A player contract isn’t just about the total money.

It’s about how that money is *structured*.

Here are the three pillars of every major deal:

1. Guaranteed Money — the amount the player gets no matter what.
Whether they get injured, traded, waived — this is the secure portion.

2. Incentives — bonuses tied to performance:

- games played
- points or stats
- awards
- team accomplishments

These reward upside but shift risk onto the player.

3. Duration and Risk — how long the team commits to you.

Short deals = flexibility for the team.

Long deals = security for the player.

Every negotiation is a balancing act between **stability** and **upside**.

Think of it like insurance:

- The player protects themselves from injury or regression.
- The team protects itself from decline or overpaying.

That tension is the entire art of contract design.”

PART 2 — The Agent’s Math (03:00–05:00)

“A good agent doesn’t just walk in and ask for ‘more money.’

They calculate **expected value** — what the contract is *actually worth* on average.

Here's a simple comparison:

Offer A:

4 years, \$80M guaranteed → Total value: \$80M.

Offer B:

3 years, \$50M guaranteed + \$30M incentives → Value: \$65–80M depending on performance.

Offer A is safe.

Offer B has higher upside but higher risk.

The agent's job is to find:

the sweet spot between security and potential.

And yes — agents typically take **3–5%**.

So the bigger the payout, the bigger their commission.

But the best agents aren't chasing dollars — they're chasing *value maximization*.

They're trying to position a player for multiple deals over a career, not one home run."

 PART 3 — The Team's Math (05:00–06:30)

"Now flip the script.

What does the front office see?

For teams, contracts are all about **cap management**.

If you guarantee too much money, your cap gets clogged — even if the player gets hurt, slows down, or gets traded.

That's why teams love:

- incentive-heavy deals
- shorter contracts
- front-loaded money
- partial guarantees

These structures give them protection against risk and flexibility if they need to rebuild or pivot.

So when you hear a GM say,

'We structured the deal to keep our options open' —
that's exactly what they mean."

PART 4 — Real-World Example (06:30–08:00)

“Let’s look across leagues, because the contract culture is totally different.

NFL:

Almost nothing is fully guaranteed.

Why? Because injury risk is massive — one hit can change everything.

Teams need flexibility.

NBA:

Fully guaranteed deals are the norm.

Small rosters mean stars have massive leverage.

MLB:

Mostly guaranteed as well — fewer catastrophic injuries and super long careers.

Same fundamental economics.

Different versions of risk.

Different incentives.

Different bargaining power.”

WRAP-UP / TAKEAWAY (08:00–08:45)

“So the next time you see a headline like:

‘Star Signs \$300 Million Contract’ —

don’t ask how big the number is.

Ask how much of it is *guaranteed*.

Because behind every shiny contract is a negotiation over risk, reward, leverage, and future value.

And now — it’s your turn.

Head to the **Contract Builder** challenge and negotiate your own deal.

Find the perfect balance between team flexibility and player security.

From the BOW Sports Capital team:

Smart agents don’t just chase money.

They create value.”

NEXT UP

Track 201 | Module 2 | Lesson 3 — “The Ownership Equation”

How owners calculate franchise value, ROI, and when to sell.

Module 2 Lesson 3

BOW Sports Capital — Track 201 | Module 2 | Lesson 3

“The Ownership Equation”

INTRO (00:00–00:45)

BRAYDEN (natural, confident):

“Hey everyone, it’s Brayden White — welcome back to BOW Sports Capital.

In our last lesson, *you* were the agent.

You were reading the room... balancing risk and reward... and figuring out how much security a player should lock in.

But today, we’re zooming all the way out — to the very top of the sports economy.

Because behind every deal... behind every contract... behind every roster move...

there’s ownership.

And ownership is where the biggest bets — and the biggest payoffs — actually happen.”

PART 1 — The Business of Owning a Team (00:45–02:30)

“Most fans think owners want one thing: championships.

But the truth is... owners think in decades, not seasons.

When Steve Ballmer bought the Clippers for two billion dollars, people said he was out of his mind.

Fast-forward ten years — the franchise is worth more than double that.

That right there?

That’s the ownership equation:

Revenue... plus brand power... plus market size... plus media rights... equals franchise value.

Winning definitely helps — of course it does.

But owners care just as much about things fans barely talk about:

- stability
- fan loyalty
- market growth
- real estate
- and media positioning

To an owner, the court is just one piece of the puzzle.

The real game... is everything *around* it.”

PART 2 — How Owners Actually Make Money **(02:30–04:00)**

“Here’s something that surprises a lot of people:

Owners don’t rely on ticket sales to get rich.

They make their money through:

- national and local media rights
- real estate around the arena
- revenue sharing
- merchandising
- sponsorships
- and long-term asset appreciation

Even a losing team can be a *winning* business.

That’s why stars are investments — not expenses.

A superstar boosts TV ratings, increases jersey sales, drives up sponsorship deals...
and all of that raises the value of the entire franchise.

Owners aren’t just buying players.

They’re buying attention.

And attention is what drives enterprise value.”



PART 3 — ROI and the Long Game (04:00–05:45)

“For an owner, ROI isn’t measured year-to-year.
It’s measured the day they sell.

If you buy a team for one billion...
and a decade later you sell it for three billion...
that’s not luck.
That’s long-term, deliberate value creation.

Every playoff run... every arena renovation... every new practice facility... every broadcast deal... it all stacks.
It all becomes part of the story of the franchise.

Owners think like long-term investors. They ask:

‘What decisions today will make this team worth more tomorrow?’
‘How does this star, this coach, this city, this stadium help us grow in the long run?’

Ownership is less about basketball or football...
and more about capital, positioning, and patience.”



PART 4 — Connecting Back to You (05:45–07:00)

“So what does all this mean for *you*?

You’re probably not an owner — at least not yet.
But the *mindset* matters.

The ownership equation is about long-term value:
building instead of reacting...
investing instead of chasing...
focusing on what something becomes, not just what it is right now.

Whether you’re building a platform, managing money, growing a career, or negotiating your first big opportunity — thinking like an owner forces you to zoom out.

It’s not about your next move.
It’s about the moves that come *after*.”

WRAP-UP / TAKEAWAY (07:00–08:00)

“There’s no simulation this time — no spreadsheet, no activity.

Because this lesson isn’t about crunching numbers.

It’s about mindset.

It’s about perspective.

Owners don’t play the game.

They own the game.

And when you understand how they think... you’ll make smarter decisions at every level beneath them — whether you’re a player, an agent, a GM, or someone trying to build something meaningful in the sports world.

From the BOW Sports Capital team... remember:

Smart agents make deals.

Smart owners build empires.”

Module 3 201

Track 201 · Module 3 · Lesson 1 — “Data to Decisions”

 **Theme:** How analytics dashboards guide real-world front-office decisions

 **Tone:** Confident, analytical, and professional — like an ESPN+ / Sloan Conference hybrid

 **Claim Code:** L1-201-M3-DATA

 **Activity:** “The Front Office Dashboard” — build your own analytic lens to evaluate a signing

SCRIPT (Full Narration Draft)

INTRO (0:00 – 0:40)

“Hey everyone, it’s Brayden White — welcome back to *BOW Sports Capital*.

We’ve talked about how money moves between teams, and how agents calculate value.

But now it’s time to see how *data* actually drives those decisions — the quiet revolution behind every trade, signing, and draft pick.

Welcome to Module 3: *Analytics in Action*.

Lesson 1 — *Data to Decisions*.”

PART 1 — The Shift (0:40 – 2:00)

“Twenty years ago, most general managers trusted their gut.

A scout’s intuition, a coach’s opinion, a few basic stats — that was enough.

Today, front offices run more like startups — powered by dashboards, models, and data scientists.

Every player is a portfolio of numbers: efficiency, durability, cost per win.

The teams that win consistently? They don’t just watch the game — they *simulate* it.”

PART 2 — What the Data Actually Says (2:00 – 4:00)

“When a front office looks at a player, they’re not asking ‘*Who’s the best?*’

They’re asking:

- *What’s the cost per win?*
- *What happens if we sign him for three years instead of five?*

- *How does he fit next to our other players?*

That's **expected value** in action — the same concept you used in Player Economics, now powered by analytics.

Basketball teams use **Adjusted Plus-Minus** to see a player's true impact.

Football teams rely on **EPA — Expected Points Added — per play** to decide which schemes are efficient.

Baseball teams live by **WAR — Wins Above Replacement** — a one-number snapshot of value.

But the real magic isn't any single stat — it's how those metrics connect.

That's why front offices build *dashboards* — visual systems that blend scouting, salary, and performance into one decision screen.”

PART 3 — The GM's Dilemma (4:00 – 5:30)

“Imagine you're a GM facing a choice between two free agents.

- Player A: 3.5 WAR, age 33, wants \$25 million a year.
- Player B: 2.8 WAR, age 27, wants \$14 million a year.

Player A helps you *right now*.

Player B gives you more *years* and less risk.

So which do you choose?

Your dashboard might tell you Player A gives you 0.14 WAR per million dollars, while Player B gives 0.20.

On paper, Player B looks more efficient.

But there's context — leadership, chemistry, ticket sales.

That's the art of it: data narrows the range of mistakes, but it doesn't replace human judgment.”

PART 4 — Economics in the Front Office (5:30 – 6:30)

“Every team faces trade-offs: short-term wins versus long-term flexibility.

In economics, that's called **opportunity cost**.

If you overpay a veteran now, you lose the chance to sign a younger breakout later.

Smart front offices run scenario models, shifting assumptions about age, injuries, and cap

growth to find the *efficient frontier* —
the best mix of talent, risk, and cost.”

PART 5 — Takeaway + Challenge (6:30 – 8:00)

“So next time you see a massive contract or a blockbuster trade, remember: behind every decision is a dashboard, a spreadsheet, and a team of analysts turning chaos into clarity.

Now it’s your turn to think like them.

Head to the activity called ‘**The Front Office Dashboard.**’

You’ll choose which metrics matter most for your team and see how your decisions play out. Balance efficiency, upside, and cost — and if you hit the sweet spot, you’ll unlock your claim code:

L1-201-M3-DATA.

From *BOW Sports Capital*, I’m Brayden White —
where data meets decision-making, and numbers turn into wins.”

Track 201 Module 3 Lesson 1



Track 201 · Module 3 · Lesson 1 — “Data to Decisions”

Full Speakable Script (Including Activity Integration)

INTRO (0:00–0:40)

“Hey everyone, it’s Brayden White — welcome back to BOW Sports Capital.
We’ve talked about how money moves between teams... and how agents calculate value.
But now it’s time to look at the engine underneath every big decision — the data.
The analytics.
The dashboards that have quietly taken over the sports world.

This is Module 3: *Analytics in Action*.
Lesson 1 — *Data to Decisions*.”

PART 1 — The Shift (0:40–2:00)

“Twenty years ago, front offices made decisions almost entirely on instinct.
A scout’s gut feeling... a coach’s hunch... maybe a few basic stats.

But today?
Front offices run more like tech companies.
They’re powered by dashboards, models, simulations, and entire analytics departments.

Every player is a portfolio of numbers:
efficiency, durability, cost per win, upside, risk.
And the teams that win consistently aren’t just watching tape —
they’re running models that predict what will happen before it happens.”

PART 2 — What the Data Actually Says (2:00–4:00)

“When a front office evaluates a player, they’re not really asking,
‘Who’s the best?’
They’re asking things like:

What’s the cost per win?

How does this contract look in year 3... and in year 5?

Does this player fit next to our core?

What’s the downside? What’s the upside?

That’s expected value — something you learned back in Player Economics — now applied with real numbers.

Basketball teams lean on Adjusted Plus-Minus.

NFL teams live by EPA, or Expected Points Added.

Baseball uses WAR — Wins Above Replacement — the closest thing to a one-number value rating.

But no single stat wins championships.

The real power comes from connecting everything — salary, age curve, risk, performance — into one decision screen.

That’s the front-office dashboard.”

PART 3 — The GM’s Dilemma (4:00–5:30)

“Imagine you’re a real GM.

You’ve got two free agents on the board:

Player A:

- 3.5 WAR
- Age 33
- Asks for 25 million a year

Player B:

- 2.8 WAR
- Age 27
- Asks for 14 million a year

Player A helps you win right now.

Player B gives you more years and way less risk.

Your dashboard might show you this:

Player A delivers about **0.14 WAR per million dollars**.

Player B gives you **0.20 WAR per million**.

So on paper, Player B is the smarter investment.
But data doesn't capture everything.
Leadership.
Locker room chemistry.
Ticket sales.
How fans respond to the signing.

And that's the balance every GM faces:
Data narrows the range of mistakes...
but it doesn't eliminate the human side of the job."

PART 4 — Economics in the Front Office (5:30–6:30)

"Every team deals with the same trade-off:
short-term wins versus long-term flexibility.

In economics, that's opportunity cost.
If you dump money into a 33-year-old star today,
you're sacrificing a chance to sign a 25-year-old breakout next summer.

That's why front offices don't just look at today.
They run simulations — different contract lengths, different injury assumptions, different cap projections — until they find the *efficient frontier*:
the best combination of talent, cost, and risk."

PART 5 — The Activity: The Front Office Dashboard (6:30–8:00)

"And now — it's your turn to make the call.

Right after this lesson, you'll open up an activity called '**The Front Office Dashboard.**'

You'll see real player profiles on your screen — WAR, age, injury risk, salary, contract years, fan appeal — all pulled into a single decision board.

Your job?

Check the boxes next to the players you want to sign... and build the most efficient roster you can.

As you make picks, the dashboard will automatically update:
your total WAR, your adjusted WAR, your salary spending, your age curve, your risk score,
your cost per win... everything.

You'll feel exactly what a real general manager feels:
Do you take the expensive veteran who gives you wins today?
Or the younger player with more upside and less risk?
Do you chase fan appeal or pure efficiency?
How much salary can you afford before your flexibility disappears?

When your efficiency score falls into the green zone —
meaning you've balanced value, upside, and risk —
you unlock your claim code for this lesson:

L1-201-M3-DATA.

From BOW Sports Capital, I'm Brayden White —
where data meets decision-making...
and numbers turn into wins.”

Track 201 Module 3 Lesson 2

woven in your updated activity (the cross-league player-picking spreadsheet).



Track 201 · Module 3 · Lesson 2

“Modeling the Market: The Analytics Deep Dive” — Speakable Script



INTRO (0:00–0:45)

“Hey everyone, it’s Brayden White — welcome back to BOW Sports Capital. Last time, we built dashboards *like a front office*. Today, we’re going deeper.

Not vibes. Not highlights.

We’re talking **the analytics that power the modern sports economy**.

We’re going inside baseball, basketball, and football — and breaking down how data turns scouting... into strategy.

This is *Modeling the Market: The Analytics Deep Dive*.

Let’s get into it.”



BASEBALL — The Blueprint of Data

OBP — On-Base Percentage

“First up: OBP — how often a player reaches base. Hits, walks, getting plunked... it all counts.

In the Moneyball era, teams realized: a guy who gets on base 38% of the time is *way* more valuable than a flashy .260 hitter who never walks.

The goal is simple: **don’t make outs**.”

SLG — Slugging Percentage

“SLG measures how many total bases you earn per at-bat.
Singles are fine — but extra-base hits are the currency.
Power drives scoring, and SLG captures it.”

OPS — On-Base + Slugging

“OPS just adds OBP and SLG.
It’s a simple snapshot of offensive value — not perfect, but super clean for comparing hitters.”

WAR — Wins Above Replacement

“WAR is the stat that GMs obsess over.
Replace a star with an average player — how many wins do you lose?
That number is WAR.
Turn performance into **wins** — and wins into **dollars**.”

wRC+ — Weighted Runs Created Plus

“wRC+ adjusts for ballparks and era.
A 120 wRC+ means a player is producing *20% more runs than league average*.
It makes analytics fair across generations — from Babe Ruth to Aaron Judge.”

BASKETBALL — The Efficiency Revolution

PER — Player Efficiency Rating

“PER takes box-score stats, adjusts for pace and playing time, and gives you one number:
How productive are you per minute?
That’s how teams find bench guys who secretly dominate in limited minutes.”

TS% — True Shooting Percentage

“TS% measures scoring efficiency across twos, threes, and free throws.
It rewards smart shot selection — not just volume.”

Usage Rate

“Usage Rate shows how often a player ends a possession.
Too high? Ball-hogging.”

Too low? You're not using a good player enough.
It's how coaches balance stars and role players."

Offensive / Defensive Rating

"Offensive Rating: points produced per 100 possessions.
Defensive Rating: points allowed per 100 possessions.
Put them together, and you get a player's true net impact."

BPM / RAPTOR / LEBRON

"These are the modern impact models — the machine-learning layer.
They adjust for teammates, opponents, context... everything.
You want to know who *really* affects winning?
These are your tools."



FOOTBALL — The Probability Game

EPA — Expected Points Added

"EPA looks at every play and asks:
How much did this change our expected points?
A seven-yard gain on 3rd and 6? Huge EPA.
The same gain on 3rd and 15? Basically nothing."

CPOE — Completion Percentage Over Expected

"CPOE adjusts accuracy for difficulty.
Not all throws are created equal.
Deep sideline lasers > screen passes."

DVOA — Defense-Adjusted Value Over Average

"DVOA compares every play to league average, adjusting for opponent.
It's the ultimate efficiency per down — and teams use it to scout players *and* entire systems."

Success Rate

"Success Rate measures how often an offense hits the goal of the play:
50% of yards on first down, 70% on second, convert on third.
High success rate = **sustainable offense**."



ECONOMIC CONNECTION (7:00–7:45)

“So why does any of this matter?

Because these stats translate straight into economics.

Teams calculate cost per WAR.

Cost per EPA.

Salary per BPM.

That’s how front offices find **market inefficiencies** — the hidden ROI.

If a \$10M player gives you the same value as a \$25M star, analytics expose that gap.

That’s where smart front offices win.”



WRAP-UP + CHALLENGE (7:45–8:15)

“Alright — time to put this into practice.

Head to your Activity: the **Analytics Matrix Draft Board**.

You’ve got players from three leagues — MLB, NBA, NFL — each with real analytics attached.

You’ll be given different scenarios:

- ‘Build the most efficient offense’
- ‘Find undervalued breakout candidates’
- ‘Maximize impact per dollar’

Your job?

Use the metrics to make the smartest picks.

Finish the activity... and you’ll unlock your claim code:

L2-201-M3-MODEL.

Because in the front office of the future...

numbers don’t just describe the game —

they decide it.”

201 M3 L3

- **SPEAKABLE SCRIPT —**
“Competitive Edges: How Front Offices Actually Win”

-  **INTRO (0:00–0:35)**
- “Hey everyone, it’s Brayden White — welcome back to BOW Sports Capital.
- Today we’re zooming out from individual metrics and looking at the bigger picture:
how real front offices create competitive edges that last.
- A competitive edge isn’t luck, and it’s not personality.
It’s the result of smarter processes, better information, and better decision-making — built and refined over time.
- This lesson is about what separates stable contenders... from teams that are constantly reacting.”

- **SECTION 1 — What Is a Competitive Edge? (0:35–2:00)**

- “When we talk about a competitive edge, we’re talking about a **structural advantage** — something baked into how an organization operates that makes it consistently more effective than its rivals.
- And in reality, a competitive edge almost always comes from a combination of things:
 - Better information
 - Better interpretation of that information
 - Cleaner communication between departments
 - Systems that improve over time
 - And a culture that actually uses data instead of ignoring it
- It’s rarely about one shiny piece of tech or one brilliant hire.
It’s about aligning research, analytics, scouting, sports science, and coaching around the same approach.
- Most teams **say** they do this.
Only a handful actually execute it.”

- **SECTION 2 — Real Examples (2:00–4:50)**

- “Let’s look at three organizations that built real, durable advantages — not trends, not hype, but actual infrastructure.”

-
- **1 Houston Astros — Pitching Development Infrastructure**
- “The Astros were early adopters of tools like Edgerton cameras and TrackMan radar. But it wasn’t just about having the tools — it was about the system they built around them.
- They used this tech to precisely measure:
 - Spin rate
 - Spin axis
 - Release characteristics
 - Pitch movement
- With that level of detail, they could identify undervalued pitchers and improve them faster than almost every other club.
That wasn’t a one-season trick.
It became a core part of their development pipeline.”

-
- **2 Golden State Warriors — Integrated Sports Science**
- “The Warriors invested heavily in sports science — not as a buzzword, but as actual infrastructure.
- They used data from wearables, sleep tracking, recovery metrics, and input from their performance staff to shape training loads, practices, and recovery routines.
- The outcome wasn’t dramatic — it was dependable.
Better availability.
More consistent performance across long seasons.
A system that protected their stars without sacrificing competitiveness.”

-
- **3 Philadelphia Eagles — Analytics in Decision-Making**
- “The Eagles built one of the most analytics-aligned front offices in football.
- Their analytics group provided real-time information during games, and the coaching staff actually listened.
In 2017, they led the NFL in fourth-down attempts — and a lot of those decisions were driven by win-probability models.
- They weren’t being ‘aggressive.’
They were being mathematically rational.
That alignment became an edge.”

-  **SECTION 3 — Economics**

Perspective (4:50–6:00)

- “Here’s the economics angle: in modern sports, data functions like capital.
- Teams that invest early and intelligently create feedback loops:
 - Better models
 - Better decisions

- More efficient spending
 - Fewer wasted opportunities
 - You don't see the payoff instantly.
But over multiple seasons, early adopters build advantages that late adopters can't easily replicate.
 - That's why front-office economics matter — competitive edges compound."
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-

• SECTION 4 — GM Takeaway (6:00–6:45)

- "Analytics don't create wins on their own.
What creates wins is the *system*:"
 - • Qualified people
 - Useful technology
 - High-quality data
 - A process for interpreting it
 - And coaches and executives who actually apply it
 - That's the blueprint modern contenders follow.
Not magic.
Not shortcuts.
Just aligned systems that get slightly smarter every year."
 -
-

• ACTIVITY — "THE FRONT OFFICE DRAFT" (6:45–8:00)

- "Now it's your turn.
- You're running a front office with a budget of **\$10 million**.
Your goal isn't to buy everything — it's to allocate resources efficiently and build an infrastructure that improves your team's decision-making over time.
- Every asset you choose has real effects:
- • Analytics Wins Added — AWA
 - Injury risk
 - Cultural alignment
 - Long-term scalability
- You're drafting your competitive edge — the system that powers your team for the next decade.
- Use your money wisely.
Build something coherent.
And when you're done, you'll unlock your claim code."
-

Module 4 201

Module 4 — Draft Economics: How Teams Build the Future

Lesson 1 — “The True Value of a Draft Pick”

Ideas included: **#2 Expected Value of Draft Picks**

Activity: “Pick Value Simulator” — choose between fake draft charts and real data to see what picks are actually worth.

Claim Code: L1-201-M4-VALUE

Why this works:

This is the FOUNDATION. Kids learn why pick #5 is not “5× better” than pick #25.

Teaches probability, salary cap cost, and expected performance.

Lesson 2 — “Rookie Contracts & Surplus Value: Sports’ Biggest Cheat Code”

Ideas included: **#5 Rookie Scale Economics**, touches #18

Activity: “Surplus Value Engine” — compare a rookie deal vs vet deal and find the best long-term ROI.

Claim Code: L2-201-M4-SURPLUS

Why this works:

This is the HEART of draft economics.

Every team wants *cheap elite talent* — this is the math behind it.

Lesson 3 — “Trade Up or Trade Down? The GM’s Dilemma”

Ideas included: **#4 Trading Up vs Down + #18 Roster Windows**

Activity: “Trade Tabletop Game” — students make 3 trade decisions under time pressure with EV math + roster windows.

Claim Code: L3-201-M4-TRADES

Why this works:

This is the *application* of Lessons 1 & 2.

It feels like being a real GM.

It lets them use EV, rookie deals, roster windows, and cost curves

Module 4 Lesson 1



TRACK 201 — MODULE 4 — LESSON 1

“The True Value of a Draft Pick”

(Speakable Script — Revised for Correct Activity)



INTRO (0:00–0:45)

“Hey everyone, I’m Brayden White — welcome back to BOW Sports Capital.

Today we’re opening Module 4, and we’re diving into one of the most important ideas in front-office economics: **The True Value of a Draft Pick**.

A draft pick isn’t just a selection — it’s a scarce, tradable, non-renewable asset.

And every GM has the same mission:

maximize the value you get per asset you spend.

To understand how smart teams do that, we need to break down two concepts: **Expected Value** and **Surplus Value** — the foundation of modern draft strategy.

Let’s get into it.”



CORE CONCEPT 1 — EXPONENTIAL DECAY (0:45–2:15)

“One of the biggest misconceptions in sports is that draft pick value is linear.

As if pick #1 is twice as valuable as pick #2, which is twice as valuable as pick #3.

That’s completely wrong.

Draft pick value declines **exponentially**.

The difference between pick 1 and pick 5 is enormous.
The difference between pick 5 and pick 50?
Much smaller.

Why?

Because the probability of getting a superstar falls off a cliff immediately after the top of the draft.

That steep drop is what creates the exponential curve.

This is the single biggest driver of real pick value.”

÷ CORE CONCEPT 2 — EXPECTED VALUE (2:15–3:45)

“Expected Value — EV — is how front offices turn probabilities into numbers they can compare.

$$EV = \sum (\text{Probability} \times \text{Value})$$

That’s it.

It’s the weighted average of all possible outcomes.

Next lesson, we’ll break down how teams calculate those probabilities using historical success rates, and how they assign value using performance metrics like WAR, Approximate Value, or RAPTOR.

But the key point right now is simple:

Teams don’t draft players.

Teams draft **Expected Value**.

If the EV of trading a pick is higher than the EV of using it, the trade is better — even if fans don’t like it.”

💰 CORE CONCEPT 3 — SURPLUS VALUE (3:45–5:15)

“The second major economic idea is **Surplus Value** — the advantage created when a rookie massively outperforms their contract.

Surplus Value = Market Value – Rookie Contract Cost

If a player performs at a \$30 million level but their rookie deal only costs \$10 million, that’s a \$20 million surplus.

This surplus is essentially *found cap space* — and it’s one of the biggest edges in sports. It’s how teams stay flexible, keep veterans, and extend championship windows.

High-EV picks create higher potential surplus.
That’s why front offices obsess over this math.”



LEAGUE APPLICATIONS

(5:15–7:15)

NFL — Trading Inefficiencies

“Old-school charts like the Jimmy Johnson model treated pick value as linear. Modern analytics based on Career Approximate Value prove the curve is exponential. Smart teams exploit this by trading down for more EV.”

NBA — Superstar Impact Curve

“One superstar can transform an entire franchise. That’s why the top three picks carry massive Expected Value — the steepest curve in any league.”

MLB — Long Timelines, NPV Thinking

“MLB teams discount future value using Net Present Value because prospects take years to reach the majors. The Bonus Pool becomes a portfolio — maximize overall EV, not individual picks.”

WRAP-UP + ACTIVITY SETUP

(7:15–7:45)

“To master draft strategy, you need to think like an economist — not a fan.

Draft picks are assets, and Expected Value and Surplus Value tell you how efficient those assets really are.

Now it's your turn.

Go to the **Pick Value Simulator**.

Use the tool to compare pick values, see the exponential curve for yourself, and answer the short quiz that follows.

Your results will unlock the claim code:

L1-201-M4-VALUE.

Welcome to Draft Economics — where winning the draft starts by winning the math.”

2 min explainer pre activity

Track 201 · Module 4 · Lesson 0

“Expected Value + Exponential Value — The GM’s Secret Weapon”

INTRO (0:00–0:20)

“Before you run the Pick Value Simulator, I want to give you the two tools every modern GM uses: Expected Value and Exponential Value. These ideas sound complicated, but the truth is... they’re simple. And once you understand them, the entire draft will start to make sense.”

PART 1 — What EV Actually Is (0:20–1:10)

“Expected Value — EV — is just the weighted average of all possible outcomes.

A draft pick can become a:

- Superstar
- Starter
- Role Player
- Bust

Each of those outcomes has a **probability** and a **value**.

EV blends those into **one number**.

Here’s the key idea:

Teams don’t draft players — they draft expected outcomes. EV is how teams compare those outcomes fairly.

EV Points are not dollars.

They aren’t WAR.

They aren’t AV.

They’re just a **score that tells you how valuable a draft pick is on average.**”



PART 2 — Exponential Value (1:10–2:00)

“The value of a draft pick does NOT drop in a straight line.

Pick 1 isn't just a little better than Pick 5.

It's *way* better.

And Pick 5 isn't that much better than Pick 12.

And Pick 12 isn't much better than Pick 20.

This is called **exponential decay** — most of the value is packed into the very top of the draft. After that, the curve flattens fast.

Why?

Because the probability of landing a Superstar collapses quickly.

The biggest drop in draft value happens in the first 5–7 picks — after that, differences get smaller and smaller.”



PART 3 — Why You Need This Now (2:00–2:20)

“When you use the Pick Value Simulator, you'll see two things:

- EV Points (Expected Value)
- A curve that drops fast at the top

These aren't accidents — they reflect how real NBA/NFL/MLB front offices think.

Once you understand EV and exponential value, you can finally evaluate a draft pick the way a GM does.”



CLOSE (2:20–2:35)

“Alright, you’re ready.

Now go run the simulator, change the pick number, compare the EV Points, and see how the draft’s value curve actually works. You’ll unlock a claim code when you finish the activity.”

Module 4 Lesson 2



TRACK 201 — MODULE 4 — LESSON 2

“Rookie Contracts & Surplus Value: Sports’ Biggest Cheat Code (and Why Synergy Matters Just as Much)”

Claim Code: L2-201-M4-SURPLUS



INTRO (0:00–0:35)

“Welcome back to BOW Sports Capital — I’m Brayden White.

Last time, we broke down Expected Value and introduced the idea of Surplus Value — the cap advantage teams get when a young player dramatically outperforms their rookie deal.

Today, we’re zooming in on that idea.

Because Surplus Value isn’t just clever accounting — it’s one of the biggest competitive edges in sports.

But here’s the part most people miss:

Surplus gives you efficiency... but synergy is what turns that efficiency into actual wins.

So let’s dive into why both matter.”



PART 1 — Why Rookie Contracts Matter (0:35–1:35)

“In the open market, veterans get paid what they’re truly worth.

A \$40 million player earns \$40 million.

But rookies?

Not even close.

Their contracts are fixed by the league — completely disconnected from their performance.

So if a rookie plays like an All-Star but earns the salary of a role player, the team gets a huge economic advantage.

That gap between what they're *worth* and what they *cost* is the beginning of Surplus Value.

And because rookie deals are short and cheap, they become the engine that powers entire championship windows."

PART 2 — Surplus Value, Expanded **(1:35–2:35)**

"Last lesson, we introduced the math.

But now let's put it into real GM context.

Surplus Value = Market Value – Rookie Contract Cost

If a young player gives you \$25 million of on-court or on-field value
but only costs \$6 million on their rookie deal,
that's **+19 million in surplus**.

That extra value isn't theoretical — it translates directly into flexibility.

That's money you can redirect to:

- Veteran role players
- Defensive specialists
- Playmakers and shooters
- Depth pieces
- An extra star if the math works

This is why so many dynasties start with at least one elite player outperforming a rookie contract."

PART 3 — How Surplus Creates **Championship Windows (2:35–3:40)**

“Look at the Warriors with early Steph,
the Chiefs with early Mahomes,
the Mavs with early Luka.

The pattern isn’t complicated:

The team’s best player was dramatically **underpaid** compared to his market value.

That gap created artificial cap space — an extra \$20–30 million that other teams didn’t have.

That’s not luck.

That’s the definition of a championship window:

when your most valuable player isn’t consuming the cap space he actually deserves.”

PART 4 — Why Surplus Isn’t Enough **(3:40–4:40)**

“But here’s where most people get stuck.

If surplus value were the whole story, team building would be easy:

‘Just stack rookies and you win.’

But real front offices know something important:

A roster isn’t a collection of contracts.

A roster is an ecosystem.

Players don’t operate alone.

Their roles collide, overlap, and depend on each other.

Surplus Value gives you **efficiency**,

but efficiency without structure doesn’t win championships.”

PART 5 — Synergy: The Multiplier **(4:40–5:50)**

“Synergy is the idea that certain players make each other better — not just statistically, but strategically.

A cheap rookie defender isn't enough on his own.
A cheap rookie scorer isn't enough on his own.
A steady veteran might look expensive — but stabilize the entire lineup.

Put them together?
Now the roster starts working.

The best teams combine:

- Efficient contracts
- Complementary roles
- Balanced strengths
- Covered weaknesses
- And a trio that raises the entire team's ceiling

Surplus Value gives you flexibility.
Synergy tells you where to spend it.”

PART 6 — Activity: The Surplus Value Championship Puzzle (5:50–7:00)

“Now it's your turn to think like a GM.

You'll be given eight players — rookies and veterans — each with:

- Salary
- Market Value
- Surplus Value
- Role tags
- Strengths and weaknesses
- Synergy interactions

Your challenge is simple:

Build a 3-player core that hits at least **+25 Surplus Value** *and* forms a strong, synergistic lineup.

There isn't only one right answer —
but only smart front offices will find the combinations that actually work.”



CLOSING (7:00–7:25)

“When you build a trio that hits the Surplus Value target and forms a balanced unit, you’ll unlock your claim code:

L2-201-M4-SURPLUS.

Open the puzzle, build your core, and let’s see if you can construct a real contender.”

Module 4 Lesson 3



TRACK 201 — MODULE 4 — LESSON 3

“Trade Up, Trade Down: The Real Chess Match of Draft Strategy”

Claim Code: L3-201-M4-TRADES



INTRO (0:00–0:45)

“Welcome back to BOW Sports Capital — I’m Brayden White.

So far in Module 4, you’ve mastered **draft pick value**, **Expected Value**, and **rookie surplus**.
Now we hit the question every real GM loses sleep over:

Do you trade up... or trade down?

Today, we’re stepping straight into the chess match — balancing Expected Value, Surplus Value, and for the first time...
your team’s **Roster Window**.

Let’s get into it.”



PART 1 — Why Trades Exist (0:45–2:00)

“Fans think trades happen because a GM ‘really likes a prospect’ or ‘panicked’ or ‘felt pressure.’

That’s not how this works.

Every trade is a **math problem**, and each team is trying to buy something different:

- A chance at a superstar
- A handful of cheap rookie contracts
- A player who fits their developmental timeline
- Or a contract structure that fits their cap window

Here's the real truth:

Trades are not equal exchanges.

Each team is trying to solve a different problem —
and that's where the smartest front offices find their edge.”



PART 2 — The Value Gap: Why Teams Trade Up (2:00–3:45)

“Trading up always comes down to one thing:

Probability mass at the top of the EV curve.

If the prospect at Pick 3 has a 35% chance to become a franchise player...
and Picks 7 and 20 each have something like 5–10%...
the Expected Value says consolidating might be worth it.

Teams that trade UP are saying:

‘Give me the shot at the one guy who changes everything.’

This is a high-risk, high-reward move — perfect for teams that have:

- ✓ No long-term star
- ✓ Time to develop talent
- ✓ Stable ownership
- ✓ A long runway to be patient

It's not emotional.

It's pure EV.”



PART 3 — Why Teams Trade Down (3:45–5:15)

“Trading down is a totally different philosophy.

These teams aren't chasing the spike outcome — they want **more rolls of the dice** at low cost.

Why trade down?

- Multiple rookie deals = multiple sources of surplus
- Depth stretches your competitive window
- Extra picks become future trade tools
- You lower your risk — you don't need ONE hit

Teams trade DOWN when they want:

- ✓ Cheap depth
- ✓ Flexibility
- ✓ Stability
- ✓ A bigger, longer window
- ✓ Optionality instead of a single bet

Trading down means:

'I don't need a superstar — I need a *system*.'



PART 4 — Roster Windows (5:15–6:45)

"This is the part almost nobody talks about.

A **Roster Window** is the period when your team is actually built to win.

Sometimes a young roster needs 3–4 years before it's ready.

Sometimes a veteran team is 12 months away from collapsing.

Sometimes the star's contract dictates the window entirely.

The right trade depends on one question:

Does this decision fit our window?

A win-now roster might trade DOWN for depth.

A rebuilding roster might trade UP for the franchise-changing swing.

A team in the middle might simply stay put.

This is the exact mental model real GMs use."



WRAP-UP (6:45–7:15)

“Today you learned the real logic behind draft trades:

Trade Up = Superstar Probability

Trade Down = Surplus + Depth

Roster Window = Which one is correct for YOU

Now it’s time for you to run the board.”

ACTIVITY — The Trade Tabletop Game (The 5-Minute GM Challenge)

“You’re going to play a mini-game — not a quiz.

Here’s how it works:

You’ll get **3 roster windows**:

1. Rebuild Window
2. Middle Window
3. Win-Now Window

And for each window, you’ll get **5 trade options**:

- 2 trade-up scenarios
- 2 trade-down scenarios
- 1 ‘stay put’ scenario

Your job:

- 1] Pick the option that best fits the roster window
- 2] Explain the GM logic
- 3] Balance EV + Surplus + Window like a real front office

Make three decisions — one per window — and if your choices match the logic of an elite GM, you’ll earn the claim code:

L3-201-M4-TRADES.

Let’s see if you can run your draft like a real front office.”

Module 1

Module 1 Lesson 3 101

caricature.



Track 101 — Lesson 3: Cap Jail

Speakable Script — Less Corny, More Direct

INTRO

“Hi everyone, I’m Brayden White, and welcome back to BOW Sports Capital — where we break down the business side of sports in a way that actually makes sense.

If you’ve been following along, you’ve drafted your roster, built your cap sheet, and made your first ownership decisions.

Today, we’re closing out Module 1 with a concept that shapes almost every major move in today’s NBA:
the Second Apron.”

HOOK

“Imagine you’ve built a strong Big Three. Your stars are elite, but your bench is thin. You try to make a trade at the deadline... and the league shuts it down.

Why?

Because you’re over the Apron — and once that happens, a lot of doors close.”

PART 1 — QUICK REVIEW

“Let’s reset the basics quickly:

The salary cap is the league’s spending guideline.

The luxury tax is what you pay if you go over it.

But there's another line above both — the Second Apron.
And crossing it changes how your front office can operate.”

PART 2 — WHAT IS THE APRON?

“Once your payroll crosses the Second Apron, the restrictions kick in.

You lose access to the mid-level exception.

You can't do sign-and-trades.

You can't take back more money than you send out in a trade.

And you can't package multiple contracts together to acquire a star.

In other words, you're not just paying more — you're losing flexibility.

Your roster becomes much harder to adjust.”

PART 3 — REAL EXAMPLE: THE PHOENIX SUNS

“Take the 2023 Phoenix Suns.

They loaded up with Kevin Durant, Bradley Beal, and Devin Booker — a ton of top-end talent.

But going over the Second Apron meant they had almost no options to improve the roster.

They couldn't use exceptions to add depth, they couldn't make certain trades, and they couldn't reshape the team when things didn't click.

They had the stars, but not the tools to fix anything around them.”

PART 4 — WHY IT MATTERS

“The Apron exists to encourage smarter planning.

Once you cross it, every decision matters more.

You can't easily undo mistakes or buy extra flexibility later.

So the real question becomes:

Not just ‘Can we afford this player?’

but ‘What are we giving up by keeping this roster the way it is?’”

WHY THERE'S NO ACTIVITY FOR THIS LESSON

“There’s no activity here on purpose.

Lesson 1 had you build a cap-compliant roster.

Lesson 2 had you make ownership-level spending decisions.

If we added another simulation now, it would just repeat concepts you’ve already used.

This lesson is about understanding the strategic side — how the Apron shapes a team’s long-term options.

When Module 2 starts, you’ll get hands-on again as we shift into how money moves through sports and how we measure player value.”

WRAP-UP

“The main takeaway is simple:

The Apron isn’t just a financial limit — it’s a strategic limit.

The best front offices aren’t just spending; they’re planning.

That wraps up Module 1 of Track 101: Rookie GM.

Next up is Module 2 — Money in Motion, where we dig into contracts, value, and how cash flows through sports.

I’m Brayden White. Thanks for listening, and I’ll see you in Module 2.”

Module 1 Lesson 1(101) Sports and payrolls



Episode 3 (Module 1: Caps & Payrolls, Lesson 1 — Salary Cap Basics)

Hook

“Sports aren’t just won on the court or the field — they’re also won on the spreadsheet. Every team has a budget for player salaries, and that budget is called the salary cap. But here’s the catch: each league does it differently. And how those caps work decides who builds dynasties, who stays competitive, and who ends up stuck rebuilding.”

Part 1 — What a Salary Cap Is

“A salary cap is the maximum amount of money a team can spend on player salaries in a season. The idea is to keep things fair — so the richest teams can’t just buy every superstar. But here’s where it gets interesting: the NBA, NFL, and MLB all handle their caps in completely different ways.”

Part 2 — NBA: The Soft Cap

“The NBA uses what’s called a *soft cap*. For 2024–25, it’s about **\$136 million**. Teams are supposed to stay under it, but there are tons of exceptions that let them go over. That’s why the Warriors could keep Steph, Klay, and Draymond — even though their total payroll plus tax in 2023 was over **\$350 million**, more than 10 entire teams combined.

So the NBA cap doesn’t stop superteams. It just makes them really expensive.”

Part 3 — NFL: The Hard Cap

“The NFL is the opposite. It has a *hard cap*. In 2024, it’s about **\$255 million**. Teams can’t go over that number — period. If a contract would push them past, the league blocks the move.

That’s why NFL rosters are so balanced. To fit under the cap, over **40% of players are on minimum deals**. That’s the only way teams can afford a few stars like Mahomes or Burrow and still fill a 53-man roster.”

Part 4 — MLB: No Cap at All

“And then you’ve got baseball — which has no salary cap at all. Teams can spend whatever they want. The only limit is a luxury tax called the ‘Competitive Balance Tax.’ In 2024, that line is about **\$237 million**.

Some teams, like the A’s, spend almost nothing. Others, like the Mets in 2023, went crazy — a **\$343 million payroll**, plus **\$100 million in tax penalties**. That’s a \$443 million bill for one season, more than the Oakland A’s franchise was even worth.”

Wrap-Up

“So here’s the takeaway:

- **NBA:** Soft cap, full of exceptions.
- **NFL:** Hard cap, no exceptions.
- **MLB:** No cap, just a tax.

And the type of cap a league uses shapes who wins. In the NFL, the hard cap creates parity — everyone plays with the same budget. In the NBA, money lets rich teams keep stars, though rules like the second apron are starting to change that. And in MLB, money can buy talent — but smart, efficient teams like the Rays still find ways to compete.

If you want to understand sports economics, you’ve got to start here: the salary cap isn’t just about money — it’s about power.”

Module 2

101 Module 2 Lesson 2

Track 101 · Module 2 · Lesson 2 — *Small Markets, Big Money*

Intro

“Hey everyone, it’s Brayden White, and welcome back to BOW Sports Capital — the show where we break down sports business so it actually makes sense for you.

In Track 101 we’ve been following how money flows—from tickets to TV to jerseys—to power a team’s operations.

Today, we’re zooming out and asking a bigger question:

How can a team from Tampa Bay or Green Bay compete alongside giants like Los Angeles and New York?

That’s what *Small Markets, Big Money* is all about.”

Hook

“Picture this: you’re the GM of a small-market franchise.

You have a loyal fan base. You’ve built a decent roster. But every time you sell out, one of the big-market clubs sells out twice and at double the price.

Their local TV deal alone is worth more than your entire annual budget.

So how do you keep up? How do you stay competitive—and financially stable—when your market size is half or a third of theirs?

The answer lies in one of the quietest yet most powerful mechanisms in sports: **revenue sharing**.”

Part 1 — What Is Revenue Sharing

“In most major leagues, teams don’t operate in isolation. They pool part of their income—especially national media rights and league-wide sponsorship deals—into a shared pot. Then every franchise receives a portion of that pot.

Take the NFL: every one of its 32 teams gets an equal share of the national TV revenue, regardless of market size. That’s why Green Bay—with a metro population of about 107,000—can operate in the same financial ecosystem as Dallas.

In contrast, leagues like the NBA and MLB still rely quite a bit on local revenues: local TV contracts, regional sponsorships, arena naming rights. That means big-market clubs can out-earn smaller ones even after sharing is applied.”



Part 2 — Case Studies: Tampa Bay Rays & Green Bay Packers

“Let’s look at two real-world examples.

The Tampa Bay Rays are one of baseball’s premier small-market success stories. They consistently make the playoffs, yet they’ve ranked among the bottom for average attendance. Their survival—and success—relies heavily on MLB’s revenue-sharing system and financial tools like luxury-tax redistribution.

On the football side, the Green Bay Packers play in a metro smaller than many college towns. Their sustained competitiveness comes because the NFL splits national broadcast revenue almost entirely equally among all teams. That means the local market size matters less for their core income.”



Part 3 — The Trade-Off

“Equal or near-equal revenue sharing is powerful ... but it comes with trade-offs.

When you share more money, big-market teams say: ‘Wait — we earned this, why do we subsidize our competition?’

When you share less, small markets struggle to keep up — and the league loses parity, fan hope, and long-term relevance.

That’s why commissioners spend more time on spreadsheets—and less time on courtside seats.”



Part 4 — Why It Matters

“Here’s the takeaway:

Competition is the product. Without it, leagues collapse. So the business model of sports isn’t just private profit—it’s **shared success**.

Small markets survive not by matching the spending of mega-markets, but by working within a system designed for equity.

If your team is in a smaller market, the numbers don’t have to be your ceiling—they can be your strategy.”



Wrap-Up / Takeaway

“So next time someone tells you a small-market team “can’t” compete, remind them:

They already do.

Not solely because they spend more—but because the league lets them survive and fight.

That’s *Small Markets, Big Money*—Lesson 2 of Module 2, Track 101.

I'm Brayden White—thanks for listening to BOW Sports Capital. Keep learning, think like a GM, and I'll see you in Lesson 3."

101 Moduel 2 Lesson 1



Module 2 — Lesson 1: Money in Motion

Speakable Script



Intro

“Every time you buy a ticket, stream a game, or wear a team’s jersey... you’re basically putting money directly into the sports system.

But where does that money actually go?

Today, we’re tracing the path of a single sports dollar — from the stands, the screen, and the store — all the way to a team’s payroll.

This is Money in Motion, the module where we break down how cash moves through sports and keeps the entire industry running.”



Section 1 — The Three Engines of Revenue

“Sports teams have tons of small income streams — parking, concessions, preseason games — but three major engines power almost everything.

First: Tickets and Game Day.

Fans in the building create instant revenue. Some teams, like the Knicks or the Cubs, depend heavily on full arenas.

Second: TV and Media Rights.

Leagues sign massive contracts with networks and streaming platforms. The NFL’s eleven-year, hundred-ten-billion-dollar deal? That’s what funds the salary cap.

Third: Merchandise and Sponsorships.

Every jersey sold, every cap, every brand partnership feeds money back into the system. Merch builds identity — and it builds profit.

Together, these create the sports value chain:

fan attention becomes revenue, and revenue becomes payroll.”



Section 2 — Small Market vs. Big Market

“Why can the Yankees spend close to three hundred million dollars, while a team like the Rays operates at a fraction of that size?

Because market size shapes revenue.

Big markets mean more fans, bigger media contracts, and stronger merchandise sales.

Small markets have fewer viewers and smaller deals — even though they still get a share of league-wide revenue.

That’s why leagues use revenue sharing: to keep competition fair so small-market teams can survive and still build contenders.

So when a team spends less, it’s not always about being cheap. It’s usually about what their market can realistically support.”



Section 3 — Where Your Money Goes

“Let’s follow a single dollar you spend on a game.

Say you buy a fifty-dollar ticket.

About five dollars covers the stadium and event operations.

Around ten dollars goes toward taxes and fees.

And roughly thirty-five dollars goes into the team’s revenue pool.

Multiply that across an entire arena, add merch sales, add media money — and that’s how teams fund the salaries you see reported on ESPN.”



Section 4 — The Hidden Balance

“But here’s the part most people never think about.

Teams don’t earn all their money at the same time they spend it.

Media checks come in long before free agency starts.

Season-ticket revenue hits months before opening night.

So teams operate like businesses managing cash flow — not just sports teams choosing players.

A good GM isn't only scouting talent.

They're forecasting how much money is coming in, how stable it is, and when they can afford to take risks."

Section 5 — Takeaway

"At the end of the day, sports finance starts with fans.

Every purchase, every view, every click helps power the entire ecosystem that pays the players.

Understanding that flow lets you think like an owner — not just a fan.

So the next time a team signs a superstar, remember: it's not magic money.

It's money in motion."

Transition to the Activity (Speakable Version)

"Now it's your turn.

In this activity, you'll step into the role of a team's CFO — the person responsible for balancing money and fans.

You'll choose your market size, set your ticket prices, estimate your revenue streams, and see how your decisions impact both profit and fan turnout.

Go too cheap and your profits collapse.

Go too aggressive and fans disappear.

Your goal is to find the balance — to hit the Efficiency Frontier — and earn your Claim Code for completing the lesson.

Ready to start your season?"

101 Module 2 Lesson 3

“Hey everyone, it’s Brayden White — welcome back to *BOW Sports Capital*.

We’ve spent this module breaking down how money moves inside a league — from revenue sharing to competitive balance to how caps shape every team decision.

So why does the salary cap exist?

Because without it, there’s no competition — only chaos.

It keeps markets equal, creates parity, and makes every win mean something.

It’s not a restriction; it’s a foundation.

For teams, it’s discipline.

For players, it’s leverage.

And for fans, it’s what makes hope real —

because on any given season, anyone can rise.

That’s the balance the cap creates —

and that’s why it’s the heartbeat of modern sports economics.

From the BOW Sports Capital team —

remember: leagues aren’t built to be fair.

They’re built to be balanced.

And that balance *is* the business.

If you made it to the end of this episode,

you’ve earned your listener claim code: **L3-101-M2-CAP**.

Enter it into your progress sheet to complete Module 2 and move onto to Module 3.

Module 3

101 Module 3 Lesson 1



Track 101 · Module 3 · Lesson 1 — “Moneyball 101: The Hidden Heroes” (Expanded Lesson)



Tone:

Curious, story-driven, accessible — you’re teaching middle schoolers how *economics meets baseball*.



Script Flow Overview

INTRO (0:00–0:40)

“Hey everyone, it’s Brayden White — welcome back to *BOW Sports Capital*.

Today we’re going to talk about something that changed sports forever — a story about numbers, baseball, and how the smallest team in the league beat the biggest ones... just by thinking differently.”

PART 1 — The Problem (0:40–2:00)

“Back in the early 2000s, the Oakland A’s had one of the lowest budgets in baseball.

They couldn’t afford the stars that teams like the Yankees or Red Sox could buy.

So their GM, Billy Beane, faced a question:

If you can’t *buy* talent... how do you *find* it?”

This sets up the **economic principle of scarcity** — limited budget, unlimited demand.

PART 2 — The Breakthrough (2:00–4:00)

“Beane and his team started asking the right question — what if the market’s wrong?

Everyone was paying for flashy stats: home runs, batting average, how a player *looked* at the plate.

But the A’s looked at a new number — **On-Base Percentage** — or OBP.

It measured how often a player *didn’t get out*.

Because every time a player got on base, the team had a chance to score — and winning games is about *scoring more runs per dollar spent*.”

(drop quick stat example here)

“Turns out, the players who got on base a lot weren’t always the ones who looked

like stars. They were cheaper — undervalued.
In economics, we'd call that a **market inefficiency**."

PART 3 — The Revolution (4:00–5:30)

"After the A's used analytics to find these 'hidden heroes,' they won 20 straight games — a record at the time.

They didn't outspend teams — they outsmarted them.

And they changed the game forever.

Today, every team — in every sport — uses some form of analytics."

PART 4 — The Takeaway (5:30–6:00)

"The *Moneyball* lesson isn't just about baseball.

It's about thinking differently.

When everyone else is chasing hype, the smartest people look for *value*.

That's the foundation of sports economics — finding wins that others miss."

ACTIVITY INTRO (6:00–6:30)

"Now it's your turn.

In the 'Moneyball Draft' activity, you'll get a list of players — some popular, some overlooked.

Your challenge is to find the best value per dollar, just like the real Oakland A's.

If you do it right, you'll unlock the claim code

That's it for this episode - See you in the next one where we understand what happens when scouts and players disagree

101 Module 3 Lesson 2

★ TRACK 101 · LESSON 2 — “Stats vs. Scouts”

Why numbers and the eye test sometimes disagree — and why smart teams need both.



SCRIPT (Final Version)

INTRO (0:00–0:40)

“Welcome back to BOW Sports Capital — Track 101.

In Lesson 1, you learned the basics of how stats help teams evaluate talent.
Today, we’re adding the second half of the equation.

Every player has two stories:

**The one your eyes tell you...
and the one the numbers tell you.**

And the truth is — those stories don’t always match.”

PART 1 — What Scouts See (0:40–1:45)

“When scouts watch a player, they’re looking for things you can’t find on a stat sheet:

- How smoothly they move
- How they react under pressure
- Their instincts
- Their defensive effort

- Their body language
- Their leadership

A good scout can spot talent, upside, and intangibles the numbers can't measure yet.

This is the *eye test* — the art of evaluation.”

PART 2 — What Stats See (1:45–3:00)

“Analytics look at the game from a totally different angle.

The numbers track thousands of plays and answer questions like:

- How efficient is this player?
- Do they help their team win when they're on the court?
- Do they defend without fouling?
- Do they create good shots or bad ones?
- Do they turn the ball over?

Stats don't care about highlights or style.
They measure *results*, not vibes.”

PART 3 — Why They Disagree (3:00–4:10)

“Here's where it gets interesting.

Sometimes scouts fall in love with a player who looks amazing...
but the numbers say he's inefficient and hurting his team.

Other times, analytics love a player who doesn't look athletic or flashy...
but the eye test sees the little things he does — the IQ, the positioning, the leadership.

And sometimes — the best cases — the stats and scouts agree completely.

The point is:
neither side is always right.
Neither side is always wrong.”

PART 4 — Real Examples (4:10–5:30)

“You’ve seen these types of players in every sport:

- The highlight scorer who takes bad shots
- The quiet role player who drives winning
- The raw prospect whose tools don’t show up in the stats yet
- The veteran who looks slow but still boosts every lineup he’s in

Great teams know this.
They don’t pick sides.
They combine the two — the art and the science.”

PART 5 — Takeaway (5:30–6:10)

“The best front offices don’t rely on just scouts or just analytics.

They ask:

What does the eye test say?
What do the numbers say?
Where do they agree?
Where do they disagree?
And what does that mean for our decision?”

That’s real talent evaluation.”

PART 6 — Transition to the Activity (6:10–7:40)

“Now you’re going to try this yourself in the Decision Lab.

You'll evaluate three different players using **both**:

- Scouting notes
- Efficiency stats

For one player, the scouts are right.

For another, the stats are right.

For another, *both* are right.

Just like real life.

Then, in the final stage, you'll make a real GM decision:

Two players.

Two contracts.

Two different stories.

Your job is to combine the scouting and the analytics to make the smartest signing.

Get all the decisions right — and you'll unlock the claim code for this lesson.”



OUTRO

“From BOW Sports Capital, I’m Brayden White.

Where the goal isn’t to choose between scouts or stats —
but to learn how to use both.

Let’s get started.”

101 Module 3 Lesson 3

★ TRACK 101 · LESSON 3 SCRIPT

“What Wins? The Four Pillars of Analytics”

Efficiency • Quality • Impact • Repeatability

INTRO (0:00–0:40)

“Welcome back to BOW Sports Capital — Track 101.

So far, we’ve talked about how analytics can disagree with the eye test, and how numbers reveal deeper truths about players.

Now we’re going to simplify something that usually feels complicated:

What are teams actually trying to measure?

Behind the thousands of charts, models, and formulas, analytics always comes back to four ideas.”

◆ PART 1 — Pillar #1: Efficiency (0:40–1:40)

“This is the most basic idea — **how much do you get for what you spend?**

In basketball:

- points per shot
- turnovers avoided

- fouls drawn
- shooting efficiency

In football:

- yards per play
- EPA per dropback
- successful runs vs wasted plays

Efficiency is the backbone of every model.

Bad efficiency means your team is wasting possessions, energy, and salary.”

PART 2 — Pillar #2: Shot/Play Quality **(1:40–2:40)**

“Analytics isn’t obsessed with makes and misses.

It’s obsessed with **quality**.”

In basketball:

Was it an open catch-and-shoot three...
or a double-team fadeaway?

In football:

Was the QB pressured?
Was the route combo designed to create separation?

A good miss is better than a bad make.

The process matters more than the outcome.”

PART 3 — Pillar #3: Lineup Impact **(2:40–3:40)**

“This is where analytics zooms out and asks:

What actually happens when this player is on the court or field?

Some players score a lot but hurt spacing.

Some don't score much but make every lineup better: better spacing, better defense, better decisions.

This is why teams track:

- on/off impact
- lineup net ratings
- two-man and five-man combinations
- spacing gravity
- defensive disruption

The impact isn't always obvious when you watch the game — but the numbers show it.”

PART 4 — Pillar #4: Repeatability **(3:40–4:40)**

"Analytics cares about one question:

Can you do this again?

Random hot streaks fool fans.

Half-court heaves fool the box score.

Deflections, shot contests, positioning, footwork — **those repeat.**

The best teams separate:

- What happened because of *skill*
vs
- What happened because of *luck*.”

◆ PART 5 — Why These Four Pillars Matter (4:40–5:20)

“Everything teams measure — EPA, WAR, RAPM, SRS, QBR, defensive metrics — all flows from the same four foundations.

If you understand these pillars, you understand analytics.
Everything else is just polishing the details.”

◆ PART 6 — Transition to the Activity (5:20–6:30)

“Now it’s your turn to think like an analyst.

You’re going to review six plays — some good, some terrible, some pure luck.
Your job is to label each one:

- **Good Process**
- **Bad Process**
- **Good Result, Bad Process**
- **Bad Result, Good Process**

Remember:

Analytics doesn’t reward luck.

Analytics rewards repeatable, high-quality decisions.

If you classify all the plays correctly, you’ll unlock the claim code for Lesson 3.”



“From BOW Sports Capital, I’m Brayden White — helping you see the game the way front offices do. Let’s get started.”

Module 4

★ TRACK 101 · MODULE 4 — “Draft Day Basics”

How teams spot talent, manage risk, and make picks on Draft Night.

This module introduces students to the **fundamentals of drafting**, focusing on intuition, probabilities, and decision-making — NOT the economic modeling (that comes in Track 201). It is the perfect bridge between basic sports economics and advanced draft analytics.

■ Lesson 1 — “Why the Draft Isn’t a Ranking”

Big Idea:

Draft picks don’t follow a linear order (#1 > #2 > #3).
The draft is a **probability game**, not a list.

Students Learn:

- Why draft outcomes are unpredictable
- Why stars come from all over the draft
- Why early picks bust and late picks break out
- The concept of **outcome ranges**, not guaranteed results
- Why scouts + analytics both matter in reducing risk

Why It Matters:

This lesson builds the *mental model* of draft chaos — which becomes the foundation for understanding **expected pick value** in Track 201.

Lesson 2 — “Floor, Ceiling, and the Prospect Pyramid”

Big Idea:

Prospects aren’t “good” or “bad” — each has a **floor**, **ceiling**, **volatility**, and **projectability**.

Students Learn:

- High-floor vs high-ceiling players
- The meaning of “boom or bust”
- Why athleticism, skills, IQ, and motor influence ceiling
- Why safe picks and risky picks BOTH have strategic value
- How teams think in terms of probability and upside

Why It Matters:

This lesson gives students the **vocabulary and intuition** behind risk, which becomes the basis for **rookie surplus value** and **contract ROI** in Track 201.

Lesson 3 — “Draft Strategy 101: Fit vs Best Player Available”

Big Idea:

Teams must decide whether to draft the **most talented player** left... or the **player who fits their roster and timeline**.

Students Learn:

- “Best Player Available” strategy (BPA)
- Drafting for role, spacing, defense, or timeline
- Why rebuilding teams draft differently from contenders
- How roster needs change pick value
- Why smart teams think in “windows” and “arcs”

Why It Matters:

This teaches the **strategic layer** of the draft, preparing students for Track 201 concepts like:

- trading up/down
 - expected value modeling
 - roster windows
 - long-term optimization
-

The Whole Module in One Sentence

Module 4 teaches students that the draft is uncertain, prospects have ranges, and smart teams draft strategically — setting up the math-heavy Draft Economics module in Track 201.

Module 4 lesson 1 101



MODULE 4 — Lesson 1

“Why the Draft Isn’t a Ranking”

(Brayden Voice — Smooth, Story-Based, Engaging)



Opening — The Misunderstanding Everyone Starts With

“Welcome back to Track 101.

Today we’re kicking off Module 4 — the Draft Module — and we’re starting with a myth that almost everyone believes when they first get into sports.

It’s this idea that the draft is basically a giant ranking.

Like... pick 1 is the best player, pick 2 is the second-best, pick 3 is the third-best, and so on.

And honestly, when you’re younger, that feels like common sense.

You look at a mock draft, people argue about who should go where, and it feels like an ordered list.

But the more you learn, the more you watch, the more you realize — wow.

That’s not even close to how the draft works.”



Part 1 — The Reality Hits You Fast

“You notice this the first time you look back at an old draft.

You’ll see a guy who went 8th... and he’s out of the league in four years.

Then you’ll see someone who went 41st... and he’s winning MVPs.

Or a quarterback taken after two other quarterbacks... and he becomes the best player in football.

You can’t explain those things if the draft is a ranking.

Rankings don’t produce chaos.

Rankings don't produce Jokic.
Rankings don't produce Tom Brady.

The draft does.”

Part 2 — What a Draft Pick Actually Represents

“So here's the mindset shift that every GM, scout, analytics department — and now you — have to make:

A draft pick is not a player.
A draft pick is a *chance* at a player.

That's it.

Pick 1 gives you a better chance of getting a star... but it doesn't promise anything.
Pick 30 gives you a lower chance... but it still gives you hope.
Pick 199?
We've seen that story before — and it literally changed the NFL.

When you realize the draft is built on chances, not certainties, suddenly everything makes sense.
The trades.
The mistakes.
The steals.
The surprises.”

Part 3 — Why the Draft Is So Wildly Unpredictable

“Let me put it in human terms.

Imagine two kids in 7th grade PE class.

One kid is already super tall, super athletic, looks like he's destined to dominate.
The other kid is small, skinny, kind of awkward.

Fast-forward four years:
The tall kid didn't improve.
The small kid grew six inches, hit the gym, and suddenly became insane.

That happens in real sports too.

Players grow, change, develop confidence, lose confidence, get the right coach, get the wrong coach, move cities, deal with injuries, mature, don't mature — and all those little things change the outcome.

So when a GM drafts someone, they're not drafting who the player *is* right now.

They're drafting who the player *might* become, in a million different versions of their future."

Part 4 — Why This Matters Going Forward

"And this idea — the idea that the draft is a set of possibilities, not a ranking — is the foundation for the rest of Module 4.

Because next lesson, we'll talk about floors and ceilings.

Why some players feel 'safe.'

Why some players feel like home-run swings.

Why some guys are called 'boom or bust' even though they're only 19.

Then, after that, we'll talk about strategy.

How teams decide between a super talented player who doesn't quite fit, versus a perfect-fit player who might not be as skilled.

All of that comes back to one idea we learned today:

You're not picking a name.

You're picking a future."

Closing — Setting Up the Activity

"To bring this to life, you're going to do a quick draft game.

I'll give you a bunch of mystery prospects — no names — and you'll rank them based on who *you* think will have the best career.

Then you'll see what actually happened to each guy.

And I can promise you right now... whatever ranking you make?

It's gonna look nothing like real life.

And that's the whole point."

Module 4 Lesson 3 101

“Draft Strategy 101: Fit vs Best Player Available”

(Podcast Script — Brayden Voice)

INTRO — “We’re Finally Thinking Like GMs”

“Hey everyone — what’s up, it’s Brayden White, back with Track 101, Module 4. And today — we enter the mind of a real GM.

Because now you understand:

- Lesson 1: The draft isn’t a ranking — it’s a probability game.
- Lesson 2: Every player has a floor, a ceiling, and volatility.

So NOW we can talk about the question that every sports fan argues about...

Should teams draft the best player available... or draft for fit?

And guess what?

Both can be right — but never for the same reason.”

PART 1 — “What Fans Think It Is”

“You’ve heard this a million times:

‘Just take the best player left!’

Or

‘No, we need a receiver!’

Or

‘We already have a point guard — why draft another one?’

Fans think the draft is like shopping:
Pick the thing your team needs most.

But GMs aren't shopping.
They're investing."

PART 2 — “Two Draft Philosophies, One Big Difference”

Best Player Available (BPA)

“This is the ‘ignore everything — take the most talented dude still on the board’ strategy.
BPA says:

- Talent survives
- Skill wins
- Good players find minutes
- And you never pass on a star to fix a short-term hole.”

NBA Example:

“When the Warriors drafted James Wiseman, many said LaMelo was BPA.
Golden State drafted for roster fit.
LaMelo became an All-Star.
Wiseman... didn't.
That's the risk of passing on BPA.”

NFL Example:

“The Chiefs drafted Patrick Mahomes while already having Alex Smith — a Pro Bowl QB.
That's BPA.
And it changed NFL history.”

Fit-Based Drafting

“This strategy says:

‘We’re building a team, not a fantasy roster.’

Fit matters because roles matter.

Especially in football, where *everyone* needs a job that complements the system.”

 Fit looks at:

- spacing
- defensive matchups
- timeline
- scheme
- position value
- contract windows

NBA Example:

“A contender might draft a 3&D wing over a raw, high-upside scorer — because they need someone who can help tomorrow.”

NFL Example:

“A team running a zone-blocking scheme won’t draft a giant power-only guard just because he’s strong.

Wrong fit = wasted pick.”



PART 3 — The Keyword: TIMELINE

“This is the most slept-on part of draft strategy.

If your team is rebuilding?

You can take risks.

High ceiling. High volatility. High upside.

Who cares if he takes 3 years to figure it out?

If your team is contending?

You cannot wait.

You take players with:

- high projectability
- low volatility
- defined roles

Because you're drafting someone to HELP RIGHT AWAY."

PART 4 — The Real Formula GMs Use

"Okay here's the secret sauce:

★ **Draft = Talent × Fit × Timeline**

If ANY of those three don't match your team,
you either:

- pass
- trade up
- trade down
- or trade out entirely.

This is why smart teams trade down for role players,
and rebuilding teams swing for the fences."

PART 5 — The Magic Question Every GM Asks

"Would this pick make sense **three years from now**,
not just today?

That's why BPA and Fit aren't enemies.
They actually work together.

You draft talent...
that fits your timeline...
in a role your team can develop...
with risk you're willing to take."

Module 4 lesson 2 101



MODULE 4 — Lesson 2

“Floor, Ceiling, and the Prospect Pyramid”

(Podcast Script — Brayden Voice, 6–8 minutes, NBA-only examples)



Opening — Why This Lesson Matters

“Alright — welcome back to Track 101, and welcome to Lesson 2.

Last time, we talked about the biggest idea in the draft:

It’s not a ranking. It’s a probability puzzle.

Today, we take the next step.

Because now that you know picks aren’t guarantees... you need to learn the language teams use to describe *risk* and *upside*.

This is where terms like **floor**, **ceiling**, **volatility**, and **projectability** come in.

If Lesson 1 was about understanding the draft...

Lesson 2 is about understanding the *players*.”



Part 1 — Floor & Ceiling (The Most Important Words)

“Let’s start with the two words every scout uses:

Floor — the worst version of this player

Ceiling — the best version of this player

Think of it like the two ends of their possible future.”

Examples:

- A player with a **high floor**:
Even if things go wrong, they’ll be an NBA rotation guy.

They're safe.

- A player with a **high ceiling**:
If everything goes right — development, fit, confidence — they could become a star.

No one enters the draft as “good” or “bad.”
They enter with a **range of futures**.”

Part 2 — High-Floor Players (Safe Bets)

“High-floor players are the guys who just *know how to play*.

They might not have insane athleticism.
They might not have superstar tools.

But they make smart decisions, they shoot well, they defend competently, and they're coachable.

Examples in the NBA:

- Malcolm Brogdon
- Desmond Bane
- Derek White

These guys came into the league with skills that translate no matter what.

They don't blow you away.
They don't bust very often.
They're **predictable**, and predictable is valuable.”

Part 3 — High-Ceiling Players (Swings)

“High-ceiling prospects are the players with *one* or *two* tools that are insane:

- explosive athleticism

- elite length
- crazy scoring flashes
- huge defensive potential
- superstar frame

They're raw, but if they figure it out?
They can completely change your franchise.

Examples:

- Giannis (raw, skinny, unknown... now MVP)
- Jaylen Brown (athlete first, skill second)
- Shai Gilgeous-Alexander (tools + flashes)

High-ceiling guys are exciting but risky.

Which brings us to..."

Part 4 — Volatility (The Boom-or-Bust Idea)

"Volatility means:
How wide is this player's range of outcomes?

Some players are steady.
Some players are wildcards.

A volatile player could become a star...
or could be unplayable.

This is why two players with the same "ceiling" can feel totally different.
One might be smooth and safe.
The other might be a total mystery box."

Part 5 — Projectability (Which Skills Translate?)

“This might be the scouting word people understand the least, but it’s one of the most important.

Projectability asks:

Which of this player’s skills will actually work in the NBA?

Example:

A college big man who dominated because he was taller than everyone...

but doesn’t have NBA-level speed or touch?

Not projectable.

A shooter who has perfect mechanics, quick release, great balance, and made 40% on high volume?

Very projectable.

Teams care less about what you do in high school or college —

and more about whether your tools **scale up**.”

Part 6 — Bringing It All Together (The Prospect Pyramid)

“Okay, so let’s tie everything together.

Every prospect can be thought of as a pyramid:

At the top is the **ceiling**.

At the bottom is the **floor**.

In the middle is the **most likely outcome**.

The width of the pyramid is the **volatility**.

And the stability of the pyramid is the **projectability**.

Every GM is basically asking:

- How good could he be?
- How bad could he be?
- How likely is each outcome?
- Which skills will age well?
- What risk am I willing to take?

That's how teams think.”

Part 7 — Why This Sets Up Lesson 3

“This vocabulary matters because next lesson we talk about **strategy**:

You might love a high-ceiling player...

but if your team is trying to win right now, you might need a high-floor guy.

If you're rebuilding, maybe you swing for upside.

If you have a star already, maybe you draft for fit.

Knowing floors and ceilings is how you start actually making decisions.

This is where you start thinking like a GM.”

Closing + Activity Setup

“To practice this, you're going to do a simple activity:

You'll get **five NBA prospects**, each with floor, ceiling, and volatility descriptions.

Your job is to **label each one correctly** — high floor, high ceiling, boom-or-bust, etc.

No right or wrong answers.

Just show that you understand the vocabulary.

Let's get into it.”

BUILDING A LEAGUE

<https://braydenokley13-ux.github.io/league-in-a-box/>

Module 2 for all levels direction



Track 101 · Module 2 — Money in Motion (Foundations)

Theme: *Where the money comes from and how it funds the game.*

Less on	Title	Core Focus	Challenge / Activity	Claim Code
L1	Tickets, TV & Jerseys	Revenue streams — fan spending powers payroll	Identify which source funds most of your favorite team's payroll	L1-101-M2-REVENUE
L2	Small Markets, Big Money	Market size vs. league sharing	Case: why the Rays & A's spend less but survive	L2-101-M2-MARKET
L3	Why the Cap Exists	Balance + fairness + league stability	Mini-debate: "Should leagues abolish the cap?"	L3-101-M2-BALANCE

 **Takeaway:** money flows from fans → teams → players, and caps keep that flow sustainable.



Track 201 · Module 2 — Money in Motion (Mechanics)

Theme: *The engine of professional sports finance.*

Lesson	Title	Core Focus	Challenge / Activity	Claim Code
L1	The League as a Business	Media rights, revenue sharing, CBA basics	Analyze a real TV deal and estimate its impact on team payroll	L1-201-M2-LEAGUE
L2	Player Economics	Contracts, agents, incentives, guarantees	Compare two real contracts for risk vs reward	L2-201-M2-PLAYER

L3	Cap Space ≠ Cash Flow	Accounting money vs real cash (bonuses, deferrals)	Scenario game: create cap room without increasing cash cost	L3-201 -M2-FL OW
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 **Takeaway:** understanding cash flow separates managers from mathematicians; real GMs manage liquidity, not just limits.

Track 301 · Module 2 — The Game Outside the Game

Theme: *Sports as a global industry and financial ecosystem.*

Lesson	Title	Core Focus	Challenge / Activity	Claim Code
L1	The Business of Winning	When profit conflicts with championship goals	Case: Yankees vs A's – profit model vs performance model	L1-301 -M2-WIN
L2	Brand Power & Sponsorships	How teams monetize fans and logos	Design a sponsorship pitch for a mid-market team	L2-301 -M2-BRAND
L3	Franchise Value & Ownership	How teams appreciate like investments + global expansion	Build a five-year growth plan for a franchise	L3-301 -M2-VALUE

 **Takeaway:** franchises aren't just sports teams—they're diversified entertainment assets.

Cohesion Across Tracks

Concept	101	201	301
Perspective	Fan → Team	Team → League	League → Industry
Tone	Accessible & fun	Analytical & strategic	Executive & global

Core Skill	Understand revenue flow	Apply financial mechanics	Evaluate enterprise value
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Module 2 — Money in Motion

Track 101 · Module 2 · Lesson 1 — “Merch Madness”

Concept: Team-level revenue streams — how tickets, concessions, and merch fund payrolls.

You’ll Learn: What makes a team profitable, why fan spending matters, and how small decisions add up.

Activity: Build your team’s game-day budget. Balance merch prices, ticket sales, and concession costs to stay in the green.

Goal: End the season with positive profit without overcharging fans.

Claim Code: [L1-101-M2-MONEY](#)

XP: 100

Track 201 · Module 2 · Lesson 1 — “The League as a Business”

Concept: League-level revenue — media rights, revenue sharing, and CBAs.

You’ll Learn: How leagues grow together through collective deals, and how fairness keeps competition alive.

Activity: **The Deal Architect Challenge** — Design a multi-billion-dollar media contract that satisfies players, owners, and networks.

Goal: Strike a balanced deal that sustains league growth and avoids conflict.

Claim Code: [L1-201-M2-LEAGUE](#)

XP: 150

Track 301 · Module 2 · Lesson 1 — “The Game Outside the Game”

Concept: Macro-economics of sports — endorsements, global markets, and brand ecosystems.

You’ll Learn: How off-field money (sponsorships, apparel, international media) shapes league power and team valuation.

Activity: **Sponsorship Strategy Simulator** — Build a portfolio of endorsement and media

deals across markets, balancing exposure, risk, and return.

Goal: Reach an Efficiency Score ≥ 85 by optimizing brand ROI and global reach without overspending.

Claim Code: L1-301-M2-BRAND

XP: 200

 Progression Summary

Track	Perspectiv e	Focus Shift	Challenge Type	Key Skill
101	Team	Fan → Revenue	Budget Balancer	Profit basics
201	League	Deal → System	Negotiation Simulation	Collective economics
301	Global	Market → Brand	Strategy Simulator	Global finance analysis

Module 3 for all levels

Track 101 · Module 3 — “The Numbers Game” (Foundations of Analytics)

Tone: Fun, discovery-based, accessible — “how data changed the way my favorite team plays.”

Lesson	Title	Core Focus	Activity	Claim Code	XP
L1	“Moneyball 101”	Story of analytics revolution — A’s, OBP, efficiency over hype	“Stat Draft” — pick metrics (OBP, ERA+, PER, etc.) to build the most efficient team	L1-101-M3-MONEYBALL	100
L2	“Stats vs. Scouts”	Why numbers and the eye test sometimes disagree	Decision Lab — given scouting notes + data, choose the better signing	L2-101-M3-SCOUTS	100
L3	“Metrics that Matter”	How advanced stats (WAR, PER, EPA) capture player value	Metric Match Game — connect each stat to what it actually measures	L3-101-M3-METRICS	100

Takeaway:

Analytics don’t replace intuition—they refine it. The smartest teams blend data and instinct.

Track 201 · Module 3 — “Analytics in Action” (Applied Decision Science)

Tone: Managerial and quantitative — for aspiring front-office thinkers.

Lesson	Title	Core Focus	Activity	Claim Code	XP
L1	“Data to Decisions”	How front offices use analytics dashboards for trades and contracts	Build-a-Dashboard — choose KPIs to evaluate a potential signing	L1-201-M3-DATA	150
L2	“Modeling the Market”	Predictive analytics — projecting player value, aging curves, and risk	Regression Playground — adjust variables to predict future WAR	L2-201-M3-MODEL	150

L3	“Competitive Edges”	Analytics departments, tech stacks, and how teams turn data into wins	Organizational Draft — build your own analytics team under a budget	L3-20 1-M3- EDGE	15 0
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 **Takeaway:**
Every modern GM is part economist, part statistician, part storyteller.

Track 301 · Module 3 — “Sports as a Science” (Advanced Analytics & Innovation)

Tone: Executive + futurist — big-data strategy and global tech integration.

Lesson	Title	Core Focus	Activity	Claim Code	XP
L1	“The Analytics Arms Race”	How franchises build proprietary data models and guard them like IP	Case Study — rank leagues by their innovation edge	L1-30 1-M3- ARMS	20 0
L2	“Beyond the Box Score”	AI, wearables, biomechanics, and real-time tracking	Design a Tech Stack — choose sensors + software to maximize player output	L2-30 1-M3- TECH	20 0
L3	“Predicting the Future”	Forecasting global trends — AI scouting, gambling data, digital twins	Build a 2035 Sports Analytics Vision Plan	L3-30 1-M3- FUTURE	

TRACK 101

Lesson 1 — “Moneyball 101”

Core Idea: How stats helped small-market teams compete with the giants.

Sports: Start with *Moneyball* (A’s), but bring in *Knicks cap space* and *Jets value contracts*.

Economics Twist: “Bang for your buck” — the idea of **efficiency**.

Activity → “The Value Draft”

- Each student gets a \$30 million “team budget.”
- They pick 3 players from cards showing *cost* + *one simple stat* (e.g., OBP = .380, PPG = 25, EPA = +0.2).
- Spreadsheet or slides calculate who built the **most efficient team**.

 Claim Code: **L1-101-M3-MONEYBALL**

Takeaway: Smart teams don’t buy stars — they buy *value*.

Lesson 2 — “Stats vs. Scouts”

Core Idea: Numbers vs. gut feel — and why both matter.

Sports: Use examples like Tom Brady’s combine picture  vs. his career stats , or Draymond Green’s “intangibles.”

Economics Twist: Sometimes hype = overpaying; data finds the deals.

Activity → “The Contract Call”

- Compare 2 players: flashy highlight-reel guy vs. consistent “analytics darling.”
- Choose who to sign for a 3-year deal.
- Reveal who gives **more wins per dollar**.

 Claim Code: **L2-101-M3-SCOUTS**

Takeaway: The best GMs mix **heart + math**.

Lesson 3 — “The Metric Game”

Core Idea: Every sport has its own “language of value.”

Sports:

- Basketball → Efficiency (PER)
- Football → Expected Points (EPA)
- Soccer → Expected Goals (xG)
- Baseball → WAR
Economics Twist: Stats turn *performance* into *price tags*.
Activity → “The Agent’s Playbook”
- You’re an agent negotiating your player’s next contract.
- You get their stat line (points, goals, etc.) and must pick which metric helps you argue they’re underpaid.
- Choose wisely → better metric = bigger payday.
 Claim Code: L3-101-M3-METRICS
Takeaway: Knowing the right metric means knowing your *worth*.
-

Track 201 · Module 3 — “Analytics in Action”

Tone: Smart · Managerial · Strategic — for future sports-business minds.

Tagline: “Every decision is a data decision.”

Lesson 1 — “Data to Decisions”

Core Focus: How front offices use dashboards and KPIs to evaluate players, contracts, and trades.

Economics Angle: “Return on investment” = Wins per Dollar + Cap Flexibility.

Sports Examples:

- NBA player-efficiency dashboards
- MLB trade analytics
- NFL cap-space simulators

Activity → “Front Office Dashboard Builder”

- Students choose 4 KPIs to track (Efficiency, Health Risk, Salary, Team Fit).
- They get 3 player profiles — must decide who to sign or trade for.
- The system reveals who generated the best *value index*.

 Claim Code: **L1-201-M3-DATA**

Takeaway: Great GMs don’t guess — they measure what matters.

Lesson 2 — “Modeling the Market”

Core Focus: Predictive analytics — projecting player performance, risk, and aging curves.

Economics Angle: Expected Value = Probability × Outcome — the math behind every bet.

Sports Examples:

- Baseball aging curves and WAR projections

- NFL quarterback value vs risk
- NBA shot-selection models

Activity → “The Projection Lab”

- You adjust sliders for variables (Age, Injury Risk, Trend, Team Usage).
- The model updates expected WAR / PER / EPA and total contract ROI.
- You try to beat the GM’s forecast.

■ Claim Code: **L2-201-M3-MODEL**

Takeaway: Models don’t predict the future — they prepare you for it.

Lesson 3 — “Competitive Edges”

Core Focus: How analytics departments, technology, and culture create sustained advantage.

Economics Angle: Data = Capital. The teams that invest early compound their edge.

Sports Examples:

- Astros analytics lab in MLB
- Warriors Sports Science Department
- Eagles fourth-down model

Activity → “The Front Office Draft”

- You have \$10 M to build an analytics team (data scientists, scouts, tech).
- Pick your hires → your choices affect *wins added by analytics per year*.

■ Claim Code: **L3-201-M3-EDGE**

Takeaway: Data only matters when you know how to use it — and who to hire to do it.

Clyde Frazier

Teamwork
Tenacious worth ethic
Common Sense
Motivation

TO DO

BUILD OUT ACTUAL LIKE CHAPTER thing like what each episode is and all their included links

NONPROFIT EMAILS

Volunteers?

Record!!!!

Finish Track's

Bonus modules and episodes?

IDEA: TRACK THE ECON OF TRADES JUST SUPER DEEP DIVE 6 LESSONS

MISSION 0



MISSION 0 — AUDIO SCRIPT

(Length: 55–65 seconds)

****“Welcome to Bow Sports Capital — and welcome to the front office.**

Before you start Track 101 or Track 201, this mission is your quick onboarding. Think of it like the moment a real GM steps into their new job for the first time.

Here’s how this program works. Each lesson starts with a short podcast episode — usually around five minutes. After that, you’ll complete a quick activity to apply what you learned, and then you’ll enter your claim code to earn XP, level up, and unlock badges. Everything you do moves you forward in your GM journey.

Your goal is simple: progress through your track at your own pace, learn how real front offices make decisions, and build the skills that actually matter — from evaluating players, to understanding contracts, to thinking the way real executives do.

For Mission Zero, all you have to do is answer a short quiz, enter your welcome claim code, and choose the track you want to start with. That’s it — and you’ll earn your first chunk of XP right away.

You’re officially in the league now. Let’s get started.”**

One quick thing - with the claim code for this episode when you are submitting it pls put it down as track 101 module 1 lesson 5. I repeat - track 101 module 1 lesson 5.

BOW 201 Front office workshop 4 week plan

★ THE FINAL 4-WEEK BOW FRONT OFFICE WORKSHOP

“THE GM CRISIS PROGRAM: 4 Weeks To Fix a Broken Franchise”

(Designed explicitly for Track 201-level students)

- One overarching storyline
- Each week corresponds to a Track 201 module
- Short teaching → BIG simulation → Individual upload
- Claim codes of varying value
- Competitive-but-everyone-advances
- Serious, immersive, fun, cinematic

Ready? Here's the **real version**.

● WEEK 1 — CAPS & PAYROLL

Module 201.1 — Cap Strategy

Storyline Chapter 1: “You’re Hired.”

Your franchise is capped out, inflexible, and stuck in mediocrity.
Ownership tells you:

“In 48 hours, I want a new direction. Fix our books or fix your résumé.”

6–8 Minute Theme:

“Your cap sheet IS your identity.”

You teach:

- flexibility vs commitment
- cap arcs
- why mediocre contracts kill contenders
- the idea of *optionality as a skill*

★ MAIN SIMULATION (30 min): “The Cap Architecture Rebuild”

Each student receives a **Cap Disaster File** containing:

- a busted cap sheet
- 3 mediocre contracts
- 1 star with a player option
- 2 rookies needing extensions
- a useless MLE signing
- owner constraints
- league-wide crisis: *cap spike removed, apron lowered by \$5M*

Their Task → Individual Upload:

A 1-page **CAP STRATEGY MEMO** to ownership including:

1. Contract to shed + method
2. One extension they greenlight or reject
3. 2-year optionality plan
4. What identity the new cap sheet creates
5. The FIRST move they'd make if the league crisis gets worse

Submission Type: A + B + G + I

(Strategy memo + justification + cap plan + ranking)

Claim Codes (varied values):

- Deep strategic plan → **201-CAP-ELITE**
 - Solid plan → **201-CAP**
 - Basic completion → **201-CAP-MIN**
-

WEEK 2 — MONEY IN MOTION

Module 201.2 — How Money Drives Movement

Storyline Chapter 2: “The Transaction Storm”

A league crisis hits:

A star's contract becomes voidable due to a grievance ruling.

Dozens of teams panic.

6–8 Minute Theme:

“Transactions aren’t trades — they’re stories driven by money.”

You teach:

- distressed assets
- timing windows
- leverage from money
- hidden motivations (agents/ownership/tax)
- why trades often aren’t basketball decisions at all

★ MAIN SIMULATION (30 min): “The Transaction Engine Crisis”

Students get a **Dual-Team Packet**:

- Team A: desperate timeline, heavy tax
- Team B: rebuilding, tons of cap room
- Star wants out (voidable contract)
- 4 possible frameworks for movement
- Realistic salary rules simplified

Their Task → Individual Upload:

A **TRANSACTION DOSSIER** (½–1 page) including:

1. The exact transaction they executed
2. Why each side agreed (financial logic)
3. What timeline each side is playing for
4. How the crisis shaped the deal
5. A short slide (1 Google Slide) summarizing the deal visually

Submission Type: A + B + C + F

(Strategy memo + justification + slide + trade doc)

Claim Codes:

- Deep thinking → **201-MONEY-ELITE**
- Solid reasoning → **201-MONEY**
- Basic → **201-MONEY-MIN**

Module 201.3 — Applying Analytics, Not Memorizing It

Storyline Chapter 3: “The Pattern Breakers.”

Your analytics department gives you a chaotic data dump during the crisis. You must figure out what the numbers actually *mean*.

6–8 Minute Theme:

“Analytics is storytelling through patterns.”

You teach:

- scalability
- contextual stats
- identifying misleading data
- role optimization
- the idea that analytics ≠ numbers, it’s meaning-making

★ MAIN SIMULATION (30 min): “The Pattern Recognition Lab”

Students are given a **Data Packet** with:

- 3 player profiles
- per-100 stats
- game logs
- role context
- usage patterns
- synergy-style blurbs
- conflicting analytics signals (on purpose)

Their Task → Individual Upload:

An **ANALYTICS PATTERN REPORT** including:

1. Which player scales best and why
2. What pattern they discovered
3. Which number is misleading
4. A prediction for each player’s next 2 seasons
5. A 5-sentence “recommendation letter” to the coach
6. Rank the 3 players by real impact

Submission Type: B + D + E + H + I

(Justification + draft board + analytics sheet + creative GM writing + ranking)

Claim Codes:

- Deep analysis → **201-ANL-ELITE**
 - Solid → **201-ANL**
 - Basic → **201-ANL-MIN**
-

WEEK 4 — DRAFT THINKING & EV

Module 201.4 — Probability, EV, Outcome Ranges

Storyline Chapter 4: “Draft Day: The Crisis Peaks.”

The league crisis reshuffles draft intel everywhere.
You need to manage uncertainty.

6–8 Minute Theme:

“Draft strategy is EV + uncertainty + probability mass.”

Teach:

- floors/ceilings
- ranges of outcomes
- silhouette evaluation
- risk distribution
- expected surplus
- why forecasting is about ranges, not predictions

MAIN SIMULATION (30 min): “The EV Draft Board Build”

Students get a **Draft Packet** with:

- 5 prospects
- stats + archetype notes
- medical flags
- psychological profiles
- synergy notes
- boom/bust models
- risk charts
- pick-value table (simple)

Their Task → Individual Upload:

A 3-PROSPECT DRAFT BOARD SUBMISSION:

1. Their board (ranked 1–3)
2. EV explanation for #1
3. Ceiling/floor description for #2
4. Red-flag risk management for #3
5. One-sentence “If crisis worsens, pivot to ____.”
6. A visual mini-slide showing their board aesthetic

Submission Type: A + C + D + I

(Strategy memo + mini-slide + draft board + ranking)

Claim Codes:

- Advanced → **201-DRAFT-ELITE**
 - Solid → **201-DRAFT**
 - Basic → **201-DRAFT-MIN**
-

THIS IS THE FINAL, PERFECT WORKSHOP SETUP

It is:

- cinematic
- competitive-but-no-elimination
- individual uploads
- varied formats
- aligned EXACTLY to Track 201 modules
- high-level front office thinking
- fun, fast, immersive
- preparing kids to enter Track 201 legit

Week 1

Slides

★ WEEK 1 — Google Slides Deck (Slide-by-Slide)

Theme: Caps & Payroll — “The Architecture of a Franchise”

Copy/paste each slide exactly as written.

★ SLIDE 1 — Title Slide

Title:

WEEK 1 — CAPS & PAYROLL LAB

Subtitle:

“The Cap Architect Rebuild”

Bottom Line:

Track 201 Simulation Series

★ SLIDE 2 — Cinematic Opening

Header:

WELCOME TO THE FRONT OFFICE

Body:

“You walk into the facility at 7:02 AM.

The team is 38–44.

The books are a mess.

Three bad contracts.

A star player thinking of leaving.”

Footer:

You’ve just been hired to fix everything.

★ SLIDE 3 — The Ultimatum

Header:

THE OWNER'S MESSAGE

Quote (centered):

'Fix the cap sheet and give us a plan by tomorrow morning.'

Subtext:

You have 48 hours.

No excuses.

★ SLIDE 4 — Theme of Week 1

Header:

WEEK 1 THEME:

YOUR CAP SHEET IS YOUR IDENTITY

Body:

The cap determines:

- Who you can sign
 - Who you must let walk
 - Your timeline
 - Your flexibility
 - Your franchise identity
-

★ SLIDE 5 — Truth #1

Header:

TRUTH #1: Fans Think Stars Run Teams...

Big Text:

The cap sheet does.

Small text:

The cap dictates every choice before the GM even arrives.

★ SLIDE 6 — Truth #2

Header:

TRUTH #2: Optionality > Perfection

Body:

Great GMs make directionally correct choices —
not perfect ones.

★ SLIDE 7 — Cap Philosophy Slide

Header:

TWO CAP PHILOSOPHIES

Columns:

Left column:

FLEXIBILITY GM

- Shorter deals
- Preserves space
- Values options
- Avoids long commitments

Right column:

COMMITMENT GM

- Locks in core early
 - Bets on continuity
 - Creates stability
 - Accepts risk of stagnation
-

★ SLIDE 8 — What Actually Kills Teams

Header:

THE #1 CAP KILLER

Big Text:

Mediocre players on expensive, long contracts.

Small text:

\$20M for a star = good

\$20M for a non-impact starter = death

SLIDE 9 — The Future Matters More

Header:

CAP = FUTURE

Body:

The cap isn't about this season.

It's about:

- Your 2-year plan
 - Your ability to pivot
 - Your optionality under pressure
-

SLIDE 10 — League-Wide Crisis (Storyline Element)

Header:

LEAGUE CRISIS ALERT

Body:

New CBA revision removes expected cap spike.

Luxury tax threshold drops by \$5M.

Many teams are suddenly over the tax.

Bottom:

Your job just got harder.

SLIDE 11 — Activity Setup

Header:

**TODAY'S SIMULATION:
THE CAP ARCHITECT REBUILD**

Body:

You will receive:

- A broken cap sheet
- 3 bad contracts
- 2 extension decisions
- Owner constraints
- A league-wide crisis twist

You must rebuild a 2-year cap strategy.

SLIDE 12 — Your Objective

Header:

YOUR MISSION — 1 PAGE ONLY

Body:

Create a **Cap Strategy Memo** that includes:

1. Contract you would shed (and how)
 2. One extension decision
 3. Your 2-year flexibility plan
 4. Your new franchise identity
 5. One crisis contingency plan
-

SLIDE 13 — Claim Codes

Header:

CLAIM CODES FOR WEEK 1

Body:

- Elite analysis → **201-CAP-ELITE**
 - Solid analysis → **201-CAP**
 - Baseline completion → **201-CAP-MIN**
-

SLIDE 14 — Let's Begin

Header:

THE CAP ARCHITECT REBUILD STARTS NOW

Body:

Open your packet.

The clock starts immediately.

Good luck, GM.

Activity

Below is the correct, final structure — clean, functional, beautiful, and seamless.

THE SYSTEM YOU WANT (High-Level Overview)

You will create:

1 A Beautiful Google Form Simulation

- Multisection
- Clean formatting
- Front-office aesthetic
- Acts like a mini-game / choose-your-path portal

2 It automatically sends all responses to your Google Classroom gradebook

This happens because:

- Google Form → attached to Classroom assignment
- Students complete it as their “Week 1 simulation”
- Google Classroom captures their submission
- YOU grade it inside Classroom
- THEY get feedback + claim codes inside Classroom

3 You add claim codes individually via private comments

(Easy, controlled, professional, gamified)

4 The Form itself looks like a mini-website

- Header image
 - Section banners
 - Divider graphics
 - Clean layout
 - No “school vibe”
-

HOW THIS WORKS TECHNICALLY

STEP 1 — Create a Google Form

Name it:

“Week 1 — Cap Architecture Simulation (Track 201)”

In Google Classroom, create an assignment and attach the Form as a “Quiz” or “Assignment” → this syncs grading.

STEP 2 — Turn the Form into a Mini-Webpage

You’ll use:

- Header image (BOW gradient or cap-sheet aesthetic)
- Section images (small banners like “Owner Directive,” “Analytics Update,” etc.)
- Page breaks to mimic “screens”
- Descriptions for storyline text

Google Forms actually looks fantastic when formatted well.

STEP 3 — Build the Simulation Step-by-Step

Students move through 8–12 sections, each like a webpage screen.

STEP 4 — Collect Deliverables Right Inside the Form

Students will upload:

- screenshots
- mini-strategy memos
- short answers
- choices at decision points
- their final 1-page Cap Strategy Memo (Google Doc upload)

STEP 5 — You Grade in Google Classroom

Because the Form is attached to the Classroom assignment:

- All responses are collected
- Each student appears in the gradebook
- You can score them 1–10 or Pass/Fail or whatever you want
- You can leave private feedback comments
- You can add their claim code as a private comment

STEP 6 — You paste their Claim Code

For example:

- 201-CAP-ELITE
- 201-CAP
- 201-CAP-MIN

Students get it in Classroom private comments, which feels official.

★ NOW: The BEAUTIFUL, POLISHED FORM DESIGN

Below is the EXACT structure and text you will paste into the Google Form.

I'll format it so it looks like a real webpage.

★ SECTION 1 — Welcome Screen

Title:

WELCOME TO THE FRONT OFFICE SIMULATION

Description:

“You arrive at 7:02 AM.

The franchise is stuck.

The cap sheet is ugly.

Your owner is frustrated.

Your job starts now.”

Button: Start Simulation →

★ SECTION 2 — Your Franchise

Title:

THE METRO CITY METEORS — Franchise Briefing

Description (pasted beautifully):

Record: 39–43 (3 straight years)

Team Identity: None

Cap Situation: Overcommitted, inflexible

Top Contracts: 22M, 24M, 18M — none belong to star-caliber players

Bright Spot: PG Darius Cole (extension eligible)

QUESTION:

“What is the biggest cap problem you see?”

Short written answer

SECTION 3 — Owner Directive

Title:

OWNER DIRECTIVE #1

Text:

“Pick a direction.

Rebuild OR Retool OR Compete.

But stop paying for mediocrity.”

QUESTION:

“Which direction do you choose?”

- **Rebuild**
 - **Retool**
 - **Compete**
-

SECTION 4 — Analytics Department Memo

Title:

ANALYTICS UPDATE

Text:

- Evan Mercer: -1.8 EPM
- Caleb Rhodes: 11th percentile defense
- Jordan Miles: Athletic decline curve triggered
- Team is 19 points better with Darius Cole on the floor

QUESTION:

“What player is the MOST overpaid based on impact?”

Short answer

SECTION 5 — League Crisis

Title:

BREAKING NEWS — LEAGUE UPDATE

Text:

Cap spike canceled.

Luxury tax lowered by \$5M.

Your team is now \$7.5M over the tax.

QUESTION:

“What is one immediate move you’d consider?”

Short answer

SECTION 6 — Extension Decision

Title:

AGENT CALL — Darius Cole

Text:

PG Darius Cole wants a 4-year, \$112M extension.

Commit now or he tests free agency.

QUESTION:

“What is your extension decision and why?”

Short answer

★ SECTION 7 — Trade Market Simulation

Title:

THE TRADE WINDOW OPENS

Text:

Choose ONE (or choose none):

Option A:

Dump Caleb Rhodes (18M) + a 2nd → Expiring 9M

Option B:

Swap Evan Mercer (22M) → Better wing (19M) but adds 3rd year

Option C:

Dump Jordan Miles (24M) → Take back injured 20M + get a 1st

QUESTION:

“What option do you choose OR do you decline all? Explain your strategy.”

Short answer

★ SECTION 8 — Create Your Cap Strategy Memo

Title:

FINAL DELIVERABLE — UPLOAD MEMO

Description:

Upload your 1-page Cap Strategy Memo (must include all 5 parts).

UPLOAD FIELD:

File upload → Docs/PDF allowed.

★ SECTION 9 — Claim Code Placeholder

Title:

WAIT FOR GM EVALUATION

Description:

“When graded, your claim code will appear in your Google Classroom private comments. Check back within 24 hours.”

(This makes it clean.)

SECTION 10 — Track 201 Link

Title:

LEVEL UP → TRACK 201

Button:

Optional: Explore the deeper modules that cover cap management in full.

THIS IS YOUR FINAL SYSTEM.

**Clean. Aesthetic. Self-paced. Realistic.
Works seamlessly with Classroom.**

What we need to do

HERE'S EVERYTHING LEFT TO DO BEFORE WE CAN PRESENT THIS TO SCHOOLS

I'm going to give this to you in one clean, perfect list — then I'll tell you the exact order we should build it in.

PHASE 1 — Academic Layer (A)

This is the backbone that makes your course *legitimate*, *accredited-looking*, and *curriculum-aligned*.

For every lesson, we need:

✓ 1. “Economics Behind This Lesson”

- 4–6 bullet points connecting the lesson to real economics
- No jargon, but real concepts (opportunity cost, marginal returns, expected value, scarcity, incentives, game theory, compounding, etc.)

✓ 2. Mini-assessment questions (optional but powerful)

- 2–3 reflective questions per lesson
- Makes your curriculum “teacher ready”

You already have the research — I can generate everything. You do NOT need to repaste unless you want something very specific.

PHASE 2 — Course Infrastructure (C + D)

This is what schools, teachers, and parents will care about most.

✓ 3. The Track 201 Homepage

This page needs:

- Hero section
- “What is Track 201?”
- Who this is for (middle school, grades 7–9)
- Course goals
- How the XP system works
- How students navigate
- Big buttons:
 - “Start Module 1”
 - “Check XP”
 - “Submit XP”
 - “Office Hours”
 - “Course Schedule (Optional)”

✓ 4. The Student Onboarding Page

This is CRITICAL for usability.

Should include:

- Step 1: Watch the lesson
- Step 2: Do the activity
- Step 3: Submit via Google Form
- Step 4: XP updates daily

- Step 5: How to ask questions
- Step 6: How the weekly class structure works
- Code of conduct
- Recommended materials
- What happens if you miss a class
- How to get ahead / redo lessons

✓ 5. The Teacher/School Admin Page

This makes the whole thing look REAL and scalable.

Includes:

- Overview of Track 201
- Learning objectives
- Standards alignment (basic econ, decision-making, statistics)
- What teachers need (nothing — it's all done for them)
- How to facilitate the live session
- The “module overview slides” (we can make simple ones later)
- Expected weekly time
- What data they get (Looker dashboard)
- FAQs for schools



PHASE 3 — Productizing the Course for Schools

Once the course pages are built, we need:

✓ 6. A Master Course Directory

A single Notion page linking:

- All modules
- All lessons
- All activities
- XP dashboard
- Submission form
- Guidebook

This becomes your “one link to rule them all.”

✓ 7. A Teacher Guide PDF (optional)

We turn the Teacher/Admin page into a downloadable PDF.
Schools LOVE PDFs.

✓ 8. A Course Overview One-Pager (non-academic)

For pitch meetings with principals / afterschool directors.

Includes:

- What BOW Sports Capital is
 - Why kids love it
 - What they learn
 - Certification + XP system
 - Why it fits a school
-



PHASE 4 — Enrollment & Scale Prep

After the whole course is built, we need:

✓ 9. Parent Consent Form (Optional but smart)

Simple doc for schools:

- Photo/video permission
- Acceptable use
- Parent signature

✓ 10. A Google Classroom Setup Template

If schools use Google Classroom, we'll create:

- Topics
- Assignments
- Links
- XP submission reminders

✓ 11. Marketing Pack for Schools (super short)

- 2–3 flyers
- A short email you send to school administrators
- A “demo lesson” video (we can script this)



PHASE 5 — The Final Polish

(optional but VERY powerful)

✓ 12. Track 201 Certificate of Completion

Includes:

- Student name
- XP earned
- BOW branding
- Signature (Brayden)

✓ 13. Add a “Gamified Map” page

Shows progress visually — kids LOVE this.

NOW — WHAT ORDER SHOULD WE DO THIS IN?

Based on everything required...

★ **THE PERFECT ORDER (starting now)**

STEP 1 — Build Economics Behind This Lesson (Module 1 → Module 4)

We should do this FIRST so the curriculum is academically airtight.

STEP 2 — Build the Track 201 Course Homepage

This becomes the central hub.

STEP 3 — Build the Student Onboarding Page

So kids know exactly how to use the platform.

STEP 4 — Build the Teacher/Admin Page

So schools can adopt it easily.

STEP 5 — Build the Master Course Directory

So everything is stored neatly in one place.

STEP 6 — (Optional but strong) Teacher PDF + One-Pager

Good for pitching.

**FIGURE OUT HOW TO ADD THE FINAL ACTIVITY
INTO THE CLAIM CODE SCRIPT**

201 CAPSTONE

BOW TRACK 201 CAPSTONE

PATH A TEMPLATE

The BOW Economics Dossier

Purpose:

This dossier demonstrates your ability to identify a real sports-economics problem, analyze incentives and tradeoffs, and propose a logical, defensible solution.

You are not being graded on length or math. You are being graded on **clarity of thinking**.

SECTION 1 — ECONOMIC PROBLEM DEFINITION

In one clear paragraph, explain the economic problem you are solving.

Your problem must:

- Be economic (not emotional)
- Involve incentives, tradeoffs, or inefficiencies
- Exist because of rules, constraints, or limited resources
- NOT include a solution yet

Prompt to guide you:

- What isn't working?
 - Who is responding rationally to incentives?
 - Why does this create a problem?
-

SECTION 2 — CONTEXT & INCENTIVES

Explain the environment in which this problem exists.

Address:

- Who the key stakeholders are (teams, league, players, owners, fans, etc.)
- What each stakeholder is incentivized to do
- Why the current outcome makes sense economically, even if it's undesirable

This section should show that the problem is not accidental.

SECTION 3 — PROPOSED SOLUTION / STRATEGY

Describe your proposed solution.

Clearly explain:

- What changes (strategy, structure, or approach)
- What does NOT change
- Why this solution targets the root economic issue

Avoid vague claims like “this makes things fairer.”

Focus on **mechanism**, not intention.

SECTION 4 — TRADEOFFS & OPPORTUNITY COST

No solution is free. Identify the tradeoffs.

Explain:

- What is gained
- What is sacrificed
- Who benefits

- Who loses
- Why this tradeoff is acceptable

Strong answers acknowledge downsides honestly.

SECTION 5 — RISK & STRESS TEST

Explain what could go wrong.

Address:

- Key assumptions your solution depends on
- Ways teams or stakeholders could exploit the system
- Early warning signs that would show failure

This section separates surface-level work from real economic thinking.

SECTION 6 — FINAL RECOMMENDATION MEMO

Write a **short professional memo** (not an essay) answering:

“Given the problem and constraints, why is this the best available option?”

Your tone should be:

- Direct
- Confident
- Professional
- Clear

No fluff. No hype.

BOW TRACK 201 CAPSTONE

PATH B TEMPLATE

The BOW League Economics Policy Proposal

Purpose:

This proposal demonstrates your ability to analyze how league rules shape behavior and how changes to incentives affect outcomes across an entire system.

SECTION 1 — BROKEN INCENTIVE IDENTIFICATION

Clearly explain the incentive problem in the current system.

Your explanation must:

- Identify a specific rule or structure
- Explain what behavior it encourages
- Explain why that behavior is economically rational

Avoid blaming teams or players. Focus on incentives.

SECTION 2 — WHY THIS IS A PROBLEM

Explain why the incentivized behavior causes harm.

Address:

- Competitive balance
- Long-term league health

- Fan trust
- Strategic distortions

Your goal is to show *why the incentive misalignment matters*.

SECTION 3 — PROPOSED POLICY CHANGE

Describe your proposed rule or system change.

Be specific:

- What exactly changes?
- What stays fixed?
- Why this change directly affects incentives

Avoid “big picture” language without mechanics.

SECTION 4 — EXPECTED BEHAVIORAL IMPACT

Explain how teams will respond to the new incentives.

Address:

- What behaviors will increase
- What behaviors will decrease
- How rational actors adapt

This is the core economics section.

SECTION 5 — TRADEOFFS & UNINTENDED CONSEQUENCES

No policy is perfect. Acknowledge the costs.

Explain:

- New advantages created
- New loopholes that may appear
- Groups that may be disadvantaged

Strong proposals are honest, not optimistic.

SECTION 6 — LEAGUE RECOMMENDATION MEMO

Write a memo addressed to:

The League Office / Commissioner

Your memo should clearly state:

- The problem
- The solution
- Why this proposal improves the system despite tradeoffs

Professional tone required.

THE EXACT BUILD ORDER (PRINT THIS)

1. Universal rubric
2. Finalize Path A & B templates
3. Problem Discovery page
4. Capstone portal copy
5. Entry gate (Form or Doc)
6. Tracking sheet
7. Manual certification

Entry Gate rubric

Approved.

Your problem is clearly economic and grounded in real incentives and constraints. You may proceed to choose a Capstone Path and begin building your project.

As you build, keep your original problem statement visible and make sure every section of your capstone connects back to it.

TEMPLATE B — APPROVED (WITH A NUDGE)

Status:  Approved

Message:

Approved.

This is a strong problem and appropriate for the capstone. As you build, make sure you clearly explain the tradeoff involved and avoid slipping into opinions.

You may proceed to choose a Capstone Path.

TEMPLATE C — REVISE (PROBLEM TOO VAGUE)

Status:  Revise

Message:

Please revise your problem statement.

Right now, the problem is too broad or unclear to build a full capstone on. Try rewriting it so it clearly describes a specific **economic tension or incentive issue**, without proposing a solution.

Resubmit once your problem is more focused.

TEMPLATE D — REVISE (SOLUTION INCLUDED TOO EARLY)

Status:  Revise

Message:

Please revise your submission.

Your problem statement already includes a solution or recommendation. At this stage, you should only describe **what the problem is and why it exists**, not how to fix it.

Remove the solution and resubmit.

TEMPLATE E — REVISE (WEAK CONSTRAINTS)

Status:  Revise

Message:

Please revise your constraints.

At least one of the listed constraints is not a real limitation or does not meaningfully shape the problem. Think about rules, budgets, uncertainty, or tradeoffs that cannot be ignored.

Update your constraints and resubmit.

TEMPLATE F — REVISE (INCENTIVES NOT EXPLAINED)

Status:  Revise

Message:

Please revise your explanation of why this problem exists.

Focus less on what teams *should* do and more on **why rational teams behave this way given the incentives and rules**.

Resubmit once incentives are clearer.

TEMPLATE G — REVISE (WRONG DOMAIN)

Status:  Revise

Message:

Please revise your domain selection.

This problem fits better under the other problem domain. Update your domain choice and adjust your problem statement to match it, then resubmit.

BOW ID

WHAT BOW ID IS (FINAL, CANONICAL DEFINITION)

Bow ID is the permanent, issued identity of a student inside Bow Sports Capital.

It is the single record that holds:

- curriculum completion (XP)
- credentials (lesson, module, track)
- encoded status + progress
- cohort & scarcity markers
- visual identity that evolves over time

Everything in Bow **writes to the ID**.

BOW ID = 4 LAYERS (THIS IS THE KEY SCAFFOLD)

Think of Bow ID as a **stack**, not a page.

LAYER 1 — CORE IDENTITY (NON-NEGOTIABLE)

This never changes.

Stored once. Used everywhere.

Fields

- Bow ID (primary key)
- Name
- Email (behind the scenes)
- Track (101 / 201 / later)
- Cohort (F25, W26, etc.)
- Status (Active / Alumni)

Why this matters

- This replaces “account”
 - This is what students *identify as*
 - This is what they type into the Finish Form
-

LAYER 2 — PROGRESS & LEDGER (WHAT STUDENTS GRIND)

This is where XP lives.

Fields

- XP total (from claim codes)
- Level
- Level Title (Rank)
- Lessons completed
- Modules completed
- Tracks completed

Interpretation

- XP = curriculum completed
- Level = milestone
- Level title = organizational rank

No performance.

No grading.

Just progress.

LAYER 3 — CREDENTIALS (THE FORMAL OUTPUT)

This is what Bow *issues*.

Credentials are **objects**, not visuals.

Credential types

1. Lesson Credential (auto, quiet)
2. Module Credential (checkpoint)

3. Track Credential (headline)
4. (Later) Role Credential

Each credential has:

- Name
- Type
- Track
- Timestamp
- Credential Code / Hash

Important

- Credentials never expire
- Credentials never downgrade
- Credentials stack over years

Bow ID is the **credential wallet**.

LAYER 4 — ID ENCODING + COSMETIC SCARCITY (THE WOW)

This is the Fortnite-energy layer — but clean.

This layer **never affects access or learning**.

Encoding elements

Status String

BOW|201|F25|L7|XP1850|M6|ACTIVE

-

Progress Code

Y1_M3_L7

-

Clearance Flags

M3-CLEARED

T202-READY

-

Cosmetic elements

- Cohort colorway (never reused)
- Track base color
- Edition label (Issue: F25)
- Optional frame / background

These are **historical + cosmetic only**.

HOW ALL OF THIS SHOWS UP TO A STUDENT

Bow ID is **one dashboard**, not scattered.

THE BOW ID DASHBOARD (STUDENT VIEW)

SECTION 1 — ID HEADER

BOW SPORTS CAPITAL — MEMBER RECORD

Bow ID: BOW-201-F25-0427

Track: 201

Cohort: F25

Status: Active

Rank: Senior Analyst

SECTION 2 — ENCODED STATUS (WOW ZONE)

STATUS_STRING:

BOW|201|F25|L7|XP1850|M6|ACTIVE

Optional toggle:

- Show codes only

- Show decoded meanings

SECTION 3 — CURRICULUM LEDGER

XP Ledger

XP Balance: 1,850

Ledger Entries: 24

Progress Code: Y1_M3_L7

SECTION 4 — CREDENTIALS (THE HEART)

TRACK CREDENTIALS

- ✓ Track 201 – Front Office Economics & Strategy
- ✓ Track 101 – Sports Economics Foundations

MODULE CREDENTIALS (6)

- Module 1 – Salary Cap Basics
- Module 2 – Roster Construction
- Module 3 – Cap Optimization

Lesson credentials exist but are collapsed:

Lesson Credentials: 24 ([view](#))

SECTION 5 — COSMETIC / SCARCITY

ID Edition: F25

Cohort Colorway: Midnight Blue

Track Base: 201 Gold

This is where Fortnite-style pride lives.

SECTION 6 — NEXT STEP

Next Action:

Continue Track 201 – Module 4 · Lesson 1

HOW YOU BUILD THIS (REALISTIC, STEP-BY-STEP)

This is critical. You do **not** build everything at once.

PHASE 1 — MAKE BOW ID THE PRIMARY KEY (1–2 DAYS)

Changes

- Add Bow ID as required field in Finish Form
- Language shift: “log to your Bow ID”
- Bow ID stored on Users table (already there)

Outcome

- Students internalize their ID
 - Culture shift begins immediately
-

PHASE 2 — CREDENTIAL OBJECTS (NO UI YET)

Changes

- Formalize credentials in your system:
 - Lesson
 - Module
 - Track
- Tie issuance directly to claim code + completion logic

Outcome

- Credentials exist structurally

- UI can come later
-

PHASE 3 — BOW ID DASHBOARD (MVP)

Build

- One clean page
- Pulls from:
 - Users
 - XP_Ledger
 - Credentials
- Shows:
 - identity
 - XP
 - credentials
 - next step

Outcome

- Students have a “home”
 - Bow feels real
-

PHASE 4 — ENCODING LAYER (VERY LOW EFFORT, HIGH WOW)

Add

- Status string generator
- Progress code generator
- Clearance flags

No new data.
Just formatting.

Outcome

- “This is sick” moment
-

PHASE 5 — COSMETIC SCARCITY (OPTIONAL, LATER)

Add

- Cohort color constants
- Edition labels
- Background/frame options

Pure presentation.

WHAT MAKES THIS WORK

- You are **not faking performance**
 - You are **not overengineering**
 - You are using **identity, language, and structure**
 - Everything maps to data you already collect
 - Schools see rigor
 - Students feel culture
-

THE CORE INSIGHT (PLEASE READ)

You are not building:

“a feature”

You are building:

an institutional identity system that happens to run inside an afterschool class

That’s why this feels big.

FINAL LOCK-IN QUESTION (LAST ONE THAT MATTERS)

Do you want the **encoded layer** (status strings, codes, flags) to be:

- A) **Always visible** (front-and-center, power-user feel)
- B) **Toggleable** (clean by default, nerdy when expanded)

Answer **A or B** — that determines the final UI philosophy.

ChatGPT can make mistakes. Check important info.